



Galaxy Z Fold8 Ultra | Fold8

Galaxy AI ✨

EMI starting ₹ 2025/month*

Model Name	Galaxy Z Fold8 Ultra	Galaxy Z Fold8
Retail price	₹ 199999	₹ 179999
Exchange value of old device~ (Max)	₹ 90000	₹ 90000
Exchange bonus^ 	₹ 4000	₹ 4000
Instant cashback#	₹ 5000	₹ 5000
Net effective price (1 unit)	₹ 100999	₹ 80999
Per month EMI starting	₹ 2525**	₹ 2025*

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Image simulated. Samsung account login may be required for certain AI features. Actual UX/UI may differ. Samsung promotes responsible use of Artificial Intelligence (AI) features. T&C apply. *EMI amount ₹ 2025 is computed on 40 months No Cost EMI including 10 months down payment at the price of ₹ 80999 for 1 unit of Galaxy Z Fold8 12|256GB, inclusive of Exchange Value of old device, Exchange bonus with EMI at ₹ 4000 and Instant discount at ₹ 5000. EMI rounded off to nearest rupee for ease of reference. Eligibility for EMI at the sole discretion of the financiers including those listed on Samsung Finance+ (Financier T&C applies). Samsung disclaims any liabilities with the same. **EMI amount ₹ 2525 is computed on 40 months No Cost EMI including 10 months down payment at the price of ₹ 100999 for 1 unit of Galaxy Z Fold8 Ultra 12|256GB, inclusive of Exchange Value of old device, Exchange bonus with EMI at ₹ 4000 and Instant cashback at ₹ 5000. EMI rounded off to nearest rupee for ease of reference. Eligibility for EMI at the sole discretion of the financiers including those listed on Samsung Finance+ (Financier T&C applies). Samsung disclaims any liabilities with the same. ~Approximate value on exchange of 1 unit of Galaxy Z Fold7 12|256 GB. Exchange value varies basis model & condition of old device. Exchange at the sole discretion of dealer. ^Customers of Galaxy Z Fold8 Ultra 12|256GB & Galaxy Z Fold8 12|256GB are eligible for benefits of maximum exchange bonus of ₹ 8000. Customers availing any NBFC EMI will be eligible to get upto ₹ 4000 exchange bonus. Exchange Bonus as per Samsung Upgrade program, provided by brand/dealer at their sole discretion upon exchange of select devices. *Limited Period Offer and subject to availability of stocks. Aforesaid calculations are for illustrative purposes, final price at the sole discretion of retailer.

Scan to know more



Galaxy S26 Series

Galaxy AI

A blue Samsung Galaxy S23 Ultra smartphone is shown vertically, with its S Pen stylus resting against the bottom left corner. The back of the phone features a quad-camera system in the top left corner.

The world's first Privacy Display

Scan to
know more



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Image is simulated for illustrative purposes, and Samsung account login may be required for certain AI features, with actual UX/UI potentially differing. Samsung promotes responsible use of Artificial Intelligence (AI) features, and terms and conditions apply. *EMI amount of ₹ 1000/month is computed on a 40-month no-cost EMI, including a 10-month down payment at the price of ₹ 39999 for 1 unit of Galaxy S26 12|256GB inclusive of instant cashback (inclusive of all taxes) and approx. exchange value of old device. EMI rounded off to the nearest rupee for ease of reference. 40|10 is available with Bajaj Finance only. Final price at the sole discretion of retailer. Offer may be revised or withdrawn without any prior notice. **Tentative retail price of 1 unit of Galaxy S26 12|256GB, inclusive of taxes. ***Approximate value on exchange of 1 unit of Galaxy S25 12|256 GB. Exchange value varies basis model & condition of old device. Exchange at the sole discretion of dealer. *Instant Cashback of ₹ 8000 for Galaxy S26 12|256GB only. **Net Effective Price shown for 1 unit of Galaxy S26 12|256GB inclusive of Exchange value of old device and Instant Cashback. ***Privacy Display feature controls screen's viewing angle to limit peripheral vision and can be activated in Settings. Activation for specific apps is also available in Settings. Some changes in image quality may occur outside the viewing angle, and some information may still be visible to others depending on the viewing environment, such as angle or brightness. Caution is advised when exposing sensitive information.



(Please scan this QR code to view the Red Herring Prospectus and the Abridged Prospectus)

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HERO MOTORS LIMITED
(TO BE LISTED ON THE MAIN BOARD OF BSE AND NSE)

Our Company was incorporated in the name of 'Hero Briggs & Stratton Auto Private Limited' as a private limited company under the Companies Act, 1956, pursuant to a certificate of incorporation dated April 30, 1998, issued by the Registrar of Companies, Delhi and Haryana. Thereafter, our Company became a deemed public company, and the name of our Company was changed to 'Hero Briggs & Stratton Auto Limited' with effect from August 25, 1998. Pursuant to the enactment of Companies (Amendment) Act, 2000 and by effect of Section 43A(2A) of the Companies Act, 1956, our Company was again converted into a private limited company with effect from June 1, 2001, and the name of our Company was accordingly changed to 'Hero Briggs & Stratton Auto Private Limited'. Thereafter, pursuant to the termination of the joint venture agreement with Briggs & Stratton International Inc. (USA) in 2001, the name of our Company was changed to 'Hero Auto Private Limited' and a fresh certificate of incorporation dated April 10, 2003, was issued by the Registrar of Companies, Delhi and Haryana. Subsequently, the name of our Company was changed to 'Hero Auto Limited' upon conversion to a public limited company on October 30, 2003, pursuant to a fresh certificate of incorporation issued by the Registrar of Companies Delhi and Haryana. Further, pursuant to the fresh certificate of incorporation dated September 15, 2004, issued by the Registrar of Companies, Delhi and Haryana, the name of our Company was changed to 'Hero Motors Limited' to reflect the true nature of the Company's business, which is the name of our Company as on the date of the Red Herring Prospectus dated September 9, 2026 (the "RHP"). For details of changes in the name and registered office address of our Company, see '*History and Certain Corporate Matters*' on page 301 of the RHP.

Registered Office: Hero Nagar, GT Road, Ludhiana, Punjab – 141 003, India. Corporate Office: Max Square, Office level, 7th floor Plot No. C3-C, Jaypee Wishtown, Sector 129, Noida, Uttar Pradesh, 201 304, India. Telephone: +91 120 4412 000; Contact person: Sakshi Dureja, Company Secretary and Compliance Officer; E-mail: investorrelations@heromotors.com; Website: www.heromotors.com; Corporate Identity Number: U29299PB1998PLC039602

THE PROMOTERS OF OUR COMPANY ARE PANKAJ MUNJAL, CHARU MUNJAL, ABHISHEK MUNJAL AND O P MUNJAL HOLDINGS

INITIAL PUBLIC OFFER OF UP TO [•] EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹10 EACH ("EQUITY SHARES") OF HERO MOTORS LIMITED ("COMPANY" OR "ISSUER") FOR CASH AT A PRICE OF ₹[•] PER EQUITY SHARE (INCLUDING A SHARE PREMIUM OF ₹[•] PER EQUITY SHARE) ("OFFER PRICE") AGGREGATING UP TO ₹10,000.00 MILLION COMPRISING A FRESH ISSUE OF UP TO [•] EQUITY SHARES AGGREGATING UP TO ₹6,000.00 MILLION BY OUR COMPANY ("FRESH ISSUE") AND AN OFFER FOR SALE OF UP TO [•] EQUITY SHARES AGGREGATING UP TO ₹4,000.00 MILLION ("OFFERED SHARES") BY THE SELLING SHAREHOLDERS, COMPRISING UP TO [•] EQUITY SHARES AGGREGATING UP TO ₹3,950.00 MILLION BY O P MUNJAL HOLDINGS ("PROMOTER SELLING SHAREHOLDER") AND UP TO [•] EQUITY SHARES AGGREGATING UP TO ₹50.00 MILLION BY HERO CYCLES LIMITED (THE "PROMOTER GROUP SELLING SHAREHOLDER" AND TOGETHER WITH THE PROMOTER SELLING SHAREHOLDER, THE "SELLING SHAREHOLDERS"), AND SUCH OFFER FOR SALE, THE "OFFER FOR SALE", AND TOGETHER WITH THE FRESH ISSUE, THE "OFFER". THE OFFER SHALL CONSTITUTE [•] % OF THE POST-OFFER PAID-UP EQUITY SHARE CAPITAL OF OUR COMPANY.

DETAILS OF THE OFFER FOR SALE			
NAME OF THE SELLING SHAREHOLDER	TYPE	NUMBER OF EQUITY SHARES OFFERED / AMOUNT	WEIGHTED AVERAGE COST OF ACQUISITION PER EQUITY SHARE (IN ₹)*
O P Munjal Holdings	Promoter Selling Shareholder	Up to [•] Equity Shares of face value of ₹10 each aggregating up to ₹3,950.00 million	0.03 [†]
Hero Cycles Limited	Promoter Group Selling Shareholder	Up to [•] Equity Shares of face value of ₹10 each aggregating up to ₹50.00 million	10.07

* The weighted average cost of acquisition is ₹0.027 per Equity Share and has been rounded to ₹0.03. | [†] As certified by Ramesh C Agrawal & Co., Chartered Accountants by way of their certificate dated September 9, 2026.

PRICE BAND: ₹79 TO ₹84 PER EQUITY SHARE OF FACE VALUE OF ₹10 EACH.

THE FLOOR PRICE IS 7.9 TIMES THE FACE VALUE OF THE EQUITY SHARES AND THE CAP PRICE IS 8.4 TIMES THE FACE VALUE OF THE EQUITY SHARES.

BIDS CAN BE MADE FOR A MINIMUM OF 178 EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹10 EACH AND IN MULTIPLES OF 178 EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹10 EACH THEREAFTER.

THE PRICE TO EARNINGS RATIO ("P/E") BASED ON DILUTED EPS FOR FISCAL 2026 FOR OUR COMPANY AT THE LOWER END OF THE PRICE BAND (I.E. FLOOR PRICE) IS 69.30 TIMES AND AT THE UPPER END OF THE PRICE BAND (I.E. CAP PRICE) IS 73.68 TIMES AS COMPARED TO THE AVERAGE INDUSTRY PEER GROUP P/E RATIO OF 50.20 TIMES FOR FISCAL 2026.

WEIGHTED AVERAGE RETURN ON NET WORTH FOR LAST THREE FISCAL YEARS IS 7.58%.

The details of the Fresh Issue, Offer for Sale and the post Offer market capitalization of the Company, each at the Floor Price and the Cap Price, are given below:

Particulars	OFFER SIZE AND MARKET CAPITALIZATION			
	At Floor Price of ₹79 per equity share		At Cap Price of ₹84 per equity share	
	Up to No. of Equity Shares of face value of ₹10 each	Up to Amount (₹ in Million)	Up to No. of Equity Shares of face value of ₹10 each	Up to Amount (₹ in Million)
Fresh Issue	75,949,367	6,000.00	71,428,571	6,000.00
Offer For Sale	50,632,911	4,000.00	47,619,047	4,000.00
Total Offer Size	126,582,278	10,000.00	119,047,618	10,000.00
Post Offer Market Capitalization	458,736,372	36,240.00	454,215,576	38,154.00

BID/ OFFER PERIOD	BID/ OFFER OPEN
	BID/ OFFER CLOSING ON FRIDAY, 18 SEPTEMBER, 2026*

* The UPI mandate end time and date shall be at 5:00 p.m. on Bid/Offer Closing Date.

We are one of India's leading automotive technology companies engaged in designing, developing, manufacturing and supplying highly engineered powertrain solutions catering to automotive original equipment manufacturers ("OEMs") in United States, Europe, India and the Association of Southeast Asian Nations ("ASEAN") region. (Source: CRISIL Report).

THE OFFER IS BEING MADE THROUGH THE BOOK BUILDING PROCESS IN ACCORDANCE WITH REGULATION 6(1) OF THE SEBI ICDR REGULATIONS.

THE EQUITY SHARES OF THE COMPANY WILL GET LISTED ON THE MAIN BOARDS OF BSE AND NSE.

BSE SHALL BE THE DESIGNATED STOCK EXCHANGE.

• QIB PORTION: NOT MORE THAN 50% OF THE OFFER • NON-INSTITUTIONAL PORTION: NOT LESS THAN 15% OF THE OFFER • RETAIL PORTION: NOT LESS THAN 35% OF THE OFFER

IN MAKING AN INVESTMENT DECISION, PROSPECTIVE INVESTORS MUST ONLY RELY ON THE INFORMATION INCLUDED IN THE RHP AND THE TERMS OF THE OFFER, INCLUDING THE RISKS INVOLVED AND NOT RELY ON ANY OTHER EXTERNAL SOURCES OF INFORMATION ABOUT THE OFFER AVAILABLE IN ANY MANNER. IN RELATION TO PRICE BAND, POTENTIAL INVESTORS SHOULD ONLY REFER TO THE PRICE BAND ADVERTISEMENT FOR THE OFFER AND SHOULD NOT RELY ON ANY OTHER EXTERNAL SOURCES OF INFORMATION AVAILABLE IN ANY MANNER IN RELATION TO THE VALUATION OF THE COMPANY AS THESE ARE NOT ENDORSED, PUBLISHED OR CONFIRMED EITHER BY THE COMPANY OR THE BOOK RUNNING LEAD MANAGERS ("BRLMs").

In accordance with the recommendation of the Committee of Independent Directors of our company, pursuant to their resolution dated September 9, 2026, the above provided Price Band is justified based on Quantitative factors/ Key performance indicators disclosed in the "Basis for Offer Price" section on page 126 of the RHP vis-a-vis the weighted average cost of acquisition ("WACA") of primary and secondary transaction(s), as applicable, disclosed in the "Basis for Offer Price" section beginning on page 126 of the RHP and provided below in this advertisement.

RISK TO INVESTORS

For details, refer to section titled "Risk Factors" on page 21 of the RHP.

- Geographical Concentration Risk:** For Fiscals 2026, 2025 and 2024, 96.09%, 95.33% and 95.75% of our revenue from operations, respectively, was derived from India, Europe and United States collectively. An economic slowdown in these geographies/countries or tightening of laws or regulations may have an adverse impact on our business, financial condition, cash flows and results of operations.
- End-industry concentration risk:** Our business is substantially dependent on the e-bike and two-wheeler industries in India and overseas. Any adverse changes in the conditions affecting these industries can adversely impact our business, results of operations, cash flows and financial condition.
- Supplier Risk:** We depend on a limited number of suppliers for the procurement of raw materials for our production. Any interruption in the supply of raw materials could adversely affect our business, financial condition, results of operations and cash flows. The table below provides the cost of raw materials consumed sourced from our top one, top five and top 10 suppliers in the years indicated:

Supplier	Fiscal 2026		Fiscal 2025		Fiscal 2024	
	Cost of Raw Materials (₹ million)	Percentage of Total Expenses (%)	Cost of Raw Materials (₹ million)	Percentage of Total Expenses (%)	Cost of Raw Materials (₹ million)	Percentage of Total Expenses (%)
Top Supplier*	365.80	3.17%	324.44	3.03%	296.10	2.80%
Top 5 Suppliers*	1,410.63	12.23%	1,403.56	13.09%	1,393.24	13.15%
Top 10 Suppliers*	2,405.32	20.85%	2,339.32	21.82%	2,278.95	21.52%

* Suppliers may vary for each Fiscal. Our top 10 suppliers/vendors did not contribute to more than 50% of the total cost of raw materials consumed for Fiscal 2026, 2025 and 2024 on a consolidated basis.

- Business Risk:** We are subject to stringent quality, tolerance and delivery requirements from customers. Failure to comply may result in recalls, warranty claims, loss of business share, or cancellation order.
- Customer Concentration Risk:** Our business largely depends on our top 10 customers which contributed 72.89%, 78.03% and 76.96% of our revenue from operations in Fiscals 2026, 2025 and 2024. The loss of any of these customers could have an adverse effect on our business, results of operations, financial condition and cash flows. The following table sets forth our revenues from our top ten customers in the periods indicated:

Category	Fiscal 2026		Fiscal 2025		Fiscal 2024	
	Revenue from Customers (₹ million)	Percentage of Revenue from Operations	Revenue from Customers	Percentage of Revenue from Operations (%)	Revenue from Customers	Percentage of Revenue from Operations (%)
Top 10 Customers	8,661.40	72.89%	8,501.96	78.03%	8,191.86	76.96%

Note: Our top 10 customers are based on the revenue contribution of the relevant customer in the relevant Fiscals, as the case maybe.

- Technology and Product-transition Risk:** We may not be able to anticipate and respond swiftly to changing technological and market trends, as well as to develop new products aligned with customer demands in the automotive sector, which could have an adverse impact on our financial condition.
- Competition Risk:** We compete with established global players (ZF Friedrichshafen AG, Musashi Co. Ltd., BorgWarner Inc., GKN PLC, Bafang, Mahle, Shimano Inc, Rohloff, Badve Group, Sandhar Technologies, Magnum) in the powertrain solutions industry. Inability to compete effectively could adversely affect our business, financial condition, results of operations and cash flows.
- Hazardous operations Risk:** Our manufacturing operations involve hazardous activities (storage of petroleum/compressed gases, chemical handling), which could result in accidents, operational suspension, or civil/criminal liability.
- Brand and Reputation Risk:** Our business depends on maintaining brand reputation and product quality perception and any failure to do so could adversely affect customer relationships and financial performance.
- Operating Risk:** We operate six manufacturing facilities (four in India – three in Ludhiana, Punjab and one in Gautam Buddha Nagar, UP; one each in United Kingdom and Thailand), with two more under construction. Any shutdown or disruption at these facilities could reduce sales and adversely affect our operations.
- The price to earnings ratio based on diluted EPS for Fiscal 2026 for our company at the upper end of the price band is 73.68 times. The average industry price-to-earnings ratio is 50.20.

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12. The average cost of acquisition of Equity shares for Selling shareholders ranges from ₹0.03* per Equity share to ₹10.07 per Equity share and the offer at upper end of the Price Band is ₹84 per Equity Share.
- *The weighted average cost of acquisition is ₹0.027 per Equity Share and has been rounded to ₹0.03.
13. Weighted Average Return on Net Worth for Fiscals 2026, 2025 and 2024 is 7.58%.
14. Weighted average cost of acquisition of all Equity Shares transacted in the last one year, 18 months and three years preceding the date of the RHP by the Promoters, Promoter Group, Selling Shareholders and Shareholders entitled with the right to nominate directors or other rights.

Period*	Weighted Average Cost of Acquisition (in ₹)	Cap Price is 'X' times the Weighted Average Cost of Acquisition	Range of acquisition price: Lowest Price-Highest Price (in ₹)
Last 1 year	NIL	NA	NIL
Last 18 months	NIL	NA	NIL
Last 3 years	NIL	NA	NIL

- * As certified by Ramesh C Agrawal & Co., Chartered Accountants pursuant to their certificate dated September 9, 2026.
15. The three BRLMs associated with the Offer have handled 102 public issues in the past three years out of which 27 issues closed below the offer price on listing date:

Name of BRLM	Total Issues	Issues Closed below IPO price as on listing date
ICICI Securities Limited*	33	9
JM Financial Limited*	34	6
DAM Capital Advisors Limited*	13	3
Common Issues	22	9
Total	102	27

*Issues handled where there were no common BRLMs

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION FOR INVESTORS:

1. The Company has not undertaken a pre-IPO placement.
2. The Promoters or members of Promoter Group have not undertaken any transaction of Equity Shares aggregating up to 1% or more of the paid-up equity share capital of the Company from the date of the Draft Red Herring Prospectus filing till date.
3. The aggregate pre-Offer and post-Offer shareholding of our Promoters, members of the Promoter Group, the additional top 10 Shareholders and other public Shareholders of our Company, refer to the section titled “Capital Structure” on page 84 of the RHP and our price band advertisement.

BASIS FOR OFFER PRICE

The “Basis for Offer Price” on page 126 of the RHP has been updated with the above Price Band. Please refer to the website of the BRLMs: www.icicisecurities.com, www.damcapital.in, www.jmfl.com for the “Basis of Offer Price” updated for the above Price Band. (You may scan the QR code for accessing the website of ICICI Securities Limited)

AN INDICATIVE TIMETABLE IN RESPECT OF THE OFFER IS SET OUT BELOW:

Submission of Bids (other than Bids from Anchor Investors):		Bid/Offer Programme
Bid/Offer Period (except the Bid/Offer Closing Date)		BID/OFFER OPENS ON
Submission and Revision in Bids	Only between 10.00 a.m. and 5.00 p.m. IST	WEDNESDAY, 16 SEPTEMBER, 2026
Bid/Offer Closing Date*		BID/OFFER CLOSES ON
		⁽ⁱ⁾ UPI mandate end time and date shall be at 5:00 pm on Bid/Offer Closing Date.
		An indicative timetable in respect of the Offer is set out below:
		Event
		Indicative Date
Submission of electronic applications (online ASBA through 3-in-1 accounts) for RIBs, other than QIBs and Non-Institutional Investors		Finalisation of Basis of Allotment with the Designated Stock Exchange
Submission of electronic application (bank ASBA through online channels like internet banking, mobile banking and syndicate ASBA applications through UPI as a payment mechanism where Bid Amount is up to ₹500,000)		On or about Monday, 21 September, 2026
Submission of electronic applications (syndicate Non-retail, Non-individual applications of QIBs and Non-Institutional Investors)		Initiation of refunds (if any, for Anchor Investors)/unblocking of funds from ASBA Account*
Submission of Physical Applications (Bank ASBA)		On or about Tuesday, 22 September, 2026
Submission of physical applications (syndicate Non-retail, Non-individual applications where Bid Amount is more than ₹500,000)		Credit of Equity Shares to depository accounts of Allottees
		On or about Tuesday, 22 September, 2026
		Commencement of trading of the Equity Shares on the Stock Exchanges
		On or about Wednesday, 23 September, 2026
<i>* In case of (i) any delay in unblocking of amounts in the ASBA Accounts (including amounts blocked through the UPI Mechanism) exceeding two Working Days from the Bid / Offer Closing Date for cancelled / withdrawn / deleted ASBA Forms, the Bidder shall be compensated at a uniform rate of ₹100 per day or 15% per annum of the Bid Amount, whichever is higher from the date on which the request for cancellation / withdrawal / deletion is placed in the Stock Exchanges bidding platform until the date on which the amounts are unblocked (ii) any blocking of multiple amounts for the same ASBA Form (for amounts blocked through the UPI Mechanism), the Bidder shall be compensated at a uniform rate of ₹100 per day or 15% per annum of the total cumulative blocked amount except the original application amount, whichever is higher from the date on which such multiple amounts were blocked till the date of actual unblock; (iii) any blocking of amounts more than the Bid Amount, the Bidder shall be compensated at a uniform rate of ₹100 per day or 15% per annum of the difference in amount, whichever is higher from the date on which such excess amounts were blocked till the date of actual unblock; (iv) any delay in unblocking of non-allotted / partially allotted Bids, exceeding two Working Days from the Bid / Offer Closing Date, the Bidder shall be compensated at a uniform rate of ₹100 per day or 15% per annum of the Bid Amount, whichever is higher for the entire duration of delay exceeding two Working Days from the Bid / Offer Closing Date by the SCSB responsible for causing such delay in unblocking. The BRLMs shall, in their sole discretion, identify and fix the liability on such intermediary or entity responsible for such delay in unblocking. The Bidder shall be compensated in the manner specified in the SEBI ICDR Master Circular, which for the avoidance of doubt, shall be deemed to be incorporated in the agreements to be entered into between our Company with the relevant intermediaries, to the extent applicable, issued by SEBI, and any other applicable law in case of delays in resolving investor grievances in relation to blocking/unblocking of funds. The processing fees for applications made by UPI Bidders using the UPI Mechanism may be released to the remitter banks (SCSBs) only after such banks provide a written confirmation in accordance with SEBI ICDR Master Circular and any subsequent circulars or notifications issued by SEBI in this regard.</i>		
Modification/Revision/cancellation of Bids		
Upward Revision of Bids by QIBs and Non-Institutional Bidders categories [†]	Only between 10.00 a.m. and up to 4.00 p.m. IST on Bid/ Offer Closing Date	
Upward or downward Revision of Bids or cancellation of Bids by RIBs*	Only between 10.00 a.m. and up to 5.00 p.m. IST	
[*] UPI mandate end time shall be 5:00 p.m. on the Bid/ Offer Closing Date		
[†] QIBs and Non-Institutional Bidders can neither revise their bids downwards nor cancel/withdraw their bids		
On the Bid/ Offer Closing Date, the Bids shall be uploaded until:		
i 4.00 p.m. IST in case of Bids by QIBs and Non-Institutional Bidders, and		
ii until 5.00 p.m. IST or such extended time as permitted by the Stock Exchanges, in case of Bids by RIBs.		
On Bid/ Offer Closing Date, extension of time will be granted to Stock Exchanges only for uploading Bids received from the RIBs, after taking into account the total number of Bids received and as reported by the Book Running Lead Managers to the Stock Exchanges.		

* UPI mandate end time shall be 5:00 p.m. on the Bid/ Offer Closing Date

[†] QIBs and Non-Institutional Bidders can neither revise their bids downwards nor cancel/withdraw their bids

On the Bid/ Offer Closing Date, the Bids shall be uploaded until:

- i 4.00 p.m. IST in case of Bids by QIBs and Non-Institutional Bidders, and
- ii until 5.00 p.m. IST or such extended time as permitted by the Stock Exchanges, in case of Bids by RIBs.

On Bid/ Offer Closing Date, extension of time will be granted by Stock Exchanges only for uploading Bids received from the RIBs, after taking into account the total number of Bids received and as reported by the Book Running Lead Managers to the Stock Exchanges.

ASBA * Simple, Safe, Smart way of Application!!!!

*Applications Supported by Blocked Amount (“ASBA”) is a better way of applying to offers by simply blocking the fund in the bank account.

For further details, check section on ASBA.

Mandatory in public issues.
No cheque will be accepted.



UPI-Now available in ASBA for Retail Individual Investors and Non Institutional Investor applying in public issues where the application amount is up to ₹ 500,000, applying through Registered Brokers, Syndicate, CDPs & RTAs. UPI Bidders also have the option to submit the application directly to the ASBA Bank (SCSBs) or to use the facility of linked online trading, demat and bank account. Investors are required to ensure that the bank account used for bidding is linked to their PAN. Bidders must ensure that their PAN is linked with Aadhaar and are in compliance with CBDT notification dated February 13, 2020 issued by the Central Board of Direct Taxes and the subsequent press releases, including press release dated June 25, 2021 read with press release dated September 17, 2021, and CBDT circular no. 7 of 2022 dated March 30, 2022, read with press release dated March 28, 2023, and any subsequent press release in this regard.

ASBA has to be availed by all the investors except Anchor Investors. UPI may be availed by (i) Retail Individual Investors in the Retail Portion; (ii) Eligible Employees in the Employee Reservation Portion (iii) Non-Institutional Investors with an application size of up to ₹0.50 million in the Non-Institutional Portion. For more details “on the ASBA and UPI process, please refer to the details given in the Bid Cum Application Form and Abridged Prospectus and also please refer to the section “Offer Procedure” on page 513 of the RHP. The process is also available on the website of Association of Investment Bankers of India (“AIBI”) and Stock Exchanges and in the General Information Document. The Bid Cum Application Form and the Abridged Prospectus can be downloaded from the websites of the Stock Exchanges and can be obtained from the list of banks that is displayed on the website of SEBI at www.sebi.gov.in/sebiweb/other/OtherAction.do?doRecognisedFPI=yes&intmid=35 and https://www.sebi.gov.in/sebiweb/other/OtherAction.do?doRecognisedFPI=yes&intmid=43, respectively as updated from time to time. For the list of UPI apps and banks live on IPO, please refer to the link: www.sebi.gov.in. UPI Bidders Bidding using the UPI Mechanism may apply through the SCSBs and mobile applications whose names appear on the website of SEBI, as updated from time to time. Axis Bank Limited and ICICI Bank Limited have been appointed as the Sponsor Banks for the Offer, in accordance with the requirements of SEBI circular dated November 1, 2018 as amended. For Offer related queries, please contact the BRLMs on their respective email IDs as mentioned below. For UPI related queries, investors can contact NPCI at the toll free number: 18001201740 and mail Id: ipo.upi@npci.org.in.

THE EQUITY SHARES OF OUR COMPANY WILL GET LISTED ON THE MAIN BOARD PLATFORMS OF BSE AND NSE.

In case of any revision to the Price Band, the Bid/ Offer Period will be extended by at least three additional Working Days following such revision of the Price Band, subject to the Bid/ Offer Period not exceeding 10 Working Days. In cases of force majeure, banking strike or similar unforeseen circumstances, our Company, in consultation with the Book Running Lead Managers, for reasons to be recorded in writing, extend the Bid/ Offer Period for a minimum of one Working Day, subject to the Bid/ Offer Period not exceeding 10 Working Days. Any revision in the Price Band and the revised Bid/ Offer Period, if applicable, will be widely disseminated by notification to the Stock Exchanges, by issuing a public notice, and also by indicating the change on the respective websites of the Book Running Lead Managers and at the terminals of the Syndicate Members and by intimation to Self-Certified Syndicate Banks (“SCSBs”), other Designated Intermediaries and the Sponsor Banks, as applicable. In case of revision of Price Band, the Bid Lot shall remain the same.

This Offer is being made through the Book Building Process, in terms of Rule 19(2)(b) of the Securities Contract (Regulation) Rules, 1957 (“SCRR”) read with Regulation 31 of the SEBI ICDR Regulations and in compliance with Regulation 6(1) of the SEBI ICDR Regulations wherein not more than 50% of the Offer shall be available for allocation on a proportionate basis to Qualified Institutional Buyers (“QIBs”), and such portion, the “QIB Portion”, provided that our Company, in consultation with the BRLMs, may allocate up to 60% of the QIB Portion to Anchor Investors on a discretionary basis (“Anchor Investor Portion”), out of which 40% shall be available for allocation as follows: (i) 33.33% for domestic Mutual Funds; and (ii) 6.67% for Life Insurance Companies and Pension Funds, subject to valid Bids being received from the domestic Mutual Funds and Life Insurance Companies and Pension Funds, at or above the price at which allocation will be made to Anchor Investors (“Anchor Investor Allocation Price”) in accordance with the SEBI ICDR Regulations. Any under-subscription in the portion amounting to 6.67% reserved for Life Insurance Companies and Pension Funds may be allocated to domestic Mutual Funds. In the event of under-subscription or non-allocation in the Anchor Investor Portion, the balance Equity Shares shall be added to the QIB Portion (other than the Anchor Investor Portion) (the “Net QIB Portion”). Further, 5% of the Net QIB Portion shall be available for allocation on a proportionate basis to Mutual Funds only, subject to valid Bids being received at or above the Offer Price, and the remainder of the Net QIB Portion shall be available for allocation on a proportionate basis to QIB Bidders (other than Anchor Investors) including Mutual Funds, subject to valid Bids being received at or above the Offer Price. However, if the aggregate demand from Mutual Funds is less than 5% of the Net QIB Portion, the balance Equity Shares available for allocation in the Mutual Fund Portion will be added to the remaining Net QIB Portion for proportionate allocation to all QIBs. Further, not less than 15% of the Offer shall be available for allocation to Non-Institutional Bidders (out of which one-third of the portion available to Non-Institutional Bidders shall be reserved for Bidders with an application size of more than ₹0.20 million and up to ₹1.00 million and two-thirds shall be reserved for Bidders with an application size of more than ₹1.00 million, provided that the unsubscribed portion in either of the aforementioned sub-categories may be allocated to Bidders in the other sub-category) and not less than 35% of the Offer shall be available for allocation to Retail Individual Bidders in accordance with the SEBI ICDR Regulations, subject to valid Bids being received from them at or above the Offer Price. All Bidders, other than Anchor Investors, are required to participate in the Offer by mandatorily utilising the Application Supported by Blocked Amount (“ASBA”) process by providing details of their respective ASBA Account and UPI ID in case of UPI Bidders, as applicable, pursuant to which their corresponding Bid Amounts will be blocked by the or by the Sponsor Banks under the UPI Mechanism, as the case may be, to the extent of respective Bid Amounts. Anchor Investors are not permitted to participate in the Offer through the ASBA process. For further details, see “Offer Procedure” on page 513 of the RHP.

Bidders/Applicants should ensure that DP ID, PAN and the Client ID and UPI ID (for UPI Bidders bidding through UPI Mechanism) are correctly filled in the Bid cum Application Form. The DP ID, PAN and Client ID provided in the Bid cum Application Form should match with the DP ID, PAN, Client ID and UPI ID available (for UPI Bidders bidding through the UPI Mechanism) in the Depository database, otherwise, the Bid cum Application Form is liable to be rejected. Bidders/Applicants should ensure that the beneficiary account provided in the Bid cum Application Form is active. Bidders/Applicants should note that on the basis of the PAN, DP ID, Client ID and UPI ID (for UPI Bidders bidding through the UPI mechanism) as provided in the Bid cum Application Form, the Bidder/Applicant may be deemed to have authorized the Depositories to provide to the Registrar to the Offer, any requested Demographic Details of the Bidder/Applicant as available on the records of the depositories. These Demographic Details may be used, among other things, for giving Allotment Advice or unblocking of ASBA Account or for other correspondence(s) related to the Offer.

Bidders/Applicants are advised to update any changes to their Demographic Details as available in the records of the Depository Participant to ensure accuracy of records. Any delay resulting from failure to update the Demographic Details would be at the Bidders/Applicants’ sole risk.

Investors must ensure that their PAN is linked with Aadhaar and are in compliance with the notification issued by Central Board of Direct Taxes notification dated February 13, 2020 and read with press releases dated June 25, 2021, September 17, 2021 and March 28, 2023 and any subsequent press releases in this regard.

Contents of the Memorandum of Association of our Company as regards its objects: For information on the main objects of our Company, please see “History and Certain Corporate Matters” on page 301 of the RHP. The Memorandum of Association of our Company is a material document for inspection in relation to the Offer. For further details, see “Material Contracts and Documents for Inspection” on page 561 of the RHP.

Liability of the members of our Company: Limited by shares.

Amount of share capital of our Company and capital structure: As on the date of the RHP, the authorised share capital of our Company is ₹5,800,000,000 divided into 580,000,000 Equity Shares of face value of ₹10 each and ₹995,000,000 divided into 99,500,000 CCPS of face value of ₹10 each. The issued, subscribed and paid-up Equity share capital of our Company is ₹3,827,870,050 divided into 382,787,005 Equity Shares of face value of ₹10 each. For more details of the capital structure of the Company, see “Capital Structure” beginning on page 84 of the RHP.

Names of the initial signatories to the Memorandum of Association of the Company and the Number of Equity Shares Subscribed by them: The initial signatories to the Memorandum of Association of the Company are as follows: Pankaj Munjal, Charu Munjal, Abhishek Munjal and O P Munjal Holdings. For more details of the share capital history of our Company please see “Capital Structure” beginning on page 84 of the RHP.

Listing: The Equity Shares that will be offered through the RHP are proposed to be listed on the Stock Exchanges. Our Company has received ‘in-principle’ approvals from BSE and NSE for the listing of the Equity Shares pursuant to their letters each dated August 7, 2025. For the purposes of the Offer, the Designated Stock Exchange shall be BSE. A signed copy of the RHP and the Prospectus shall be delivered to the RoC for filing in accordance with Section 26(4) and Section 32 of the Companies Act. For details of the material contracts and documents that will be available for inspection from the date of this RHP up to the Bid/ Offer Closing Date, see “Material Contracts and Documents for Inspection” on page 561 of the RHP.

Disclaimer Clause of Securities and Exchange Board of India (“SEBI”): SEBI only gives its observations on the draft offer documents and this does not constitute approval of either the Offer or the specified securities stated in the Offer Documents. The investors are advised to refer to page 493 of the RHP for the full text of the disclaimer clause of SEBI.

Disclaimer Clause of BSE (the Designated Stock Exchange): It is to be distinctly understood that the permission given by BSE should not in any way be deemed or construed that the RHP has been cleared or approved by BSE nor does it certify the correctness or completeness of any of the contents of the RHP. The investors are advised to refer to the page 495 of the Red Herring Prospectus for the full text of the disclaimer clause of BSE.

Disclaimer Clause of NSE: It is to be distinctly understood that the permission given by NSE should not in any way be deemed or construed that the Offer Document has been cleared or approved by NSE nor does it certify the correctness or completeness of any of the contents of the Offer Document. The investors are advised to refer to page 495 of the RHP for the full text of the disclaimer clause of NSE.

General Risks: Investments in equity and equity-related securities involve a degree of risk and Bidders should not invest any funds in the Offer unless they can afford to take the risk of losing their investment. Bidders are advised to read the risk factors carefully before taking an investment decision in the Offer. For taking an investment decision, Bidders must rely on their own examination of our Company and the Offer, including the risks involved. The Equity Shares in the Offer have neither been recommended, nor approved by the SEBI, nor does SEBI guarantee the accuracy or adequacy of the contents of the Red Herring Prospectus. Specific attention of the Bidders is invited to “Risk Factors” on page 21 of the RHP.

BOOK RUNNING LEAD MANAGERS		REGISTRAR TO THE OFFER	COMPANY SECRETARY AND COMPLIANCE OFFICER	
 ICICI Securities Limited ICICI Venture House Appasaheb Marathe Marg Prabhadevi, Mumbai 400 025 Maharashtra, India Tel: +91 22 6807 7100 E-mail: heromotors.ipo@icicisecurities.com Investor grievance e-mail: customercare@icicisecurities.com Website: www.icicisecurities.com Contact Person: Namrata Ravasia SEBI Registration No.: INM000011179	 DAM Capital Advisors Limited Altium 2202, Level 22 Pandurang Budhkar Marg Worli, Mumbai 400018 Maharashtra, India Tel: +91 22 4202 2500 E-mail: hml.ipo@damcapital.in Investor grievance e-mail: complaint@damcapital.in Website: www.damcapital.in Contact Person: Puneet Agnihotri/ Chandresh Sharma SEBI Registration No.: MB/INM000011336	 JM Financial Limited 7 th Floor, Cnergy Appasaheb Marathe Marg Prabhadevi Mumbai 400 025 Maharashtra, India Tel: +91 22 6630 3030 E-mail: heromotors.ipo@jmfi.com Investor grievance e-mail: grievance.ibd@jmfi.com Website: www.jmfi.com Contact Person: Prachee Dhuri SEBI Registration No.: INM0000010361	 KFin Technologies Limited 301, The Centrum, 3rd Floor, 57, Lal Bahadur Shastri Road, Nav Pada, Kurla (West), Kurla, Mumbai 400070 Maharashtra, India Tel: +91 40 6716 2222 E-mail: heromotors.ipo@kfintech.com Investor grievance e-mail: einward.ris@kfintech.com Website: www.kfintech.com Contact Person: M. Murali Krishna SEBI Registration No.: INR000000221	 Sakshi Dureja HERO MOTORS LIMITED Max Square, Office level, 7 th Floor, Plot No. C3-C, Jaypee Wishtown, Sector 129, Noida, Uttar Pradesh 201 304, India Tel: +91 120 4412 000 E-mail: investorrelations@heromotors.com Website: www.heromotors.com Investors may contact the Company Secretary and Compliance Officer or the Registrar to the Offer in case of any pre-offer or post-offer related grievances including non-receipt of letters of Allotment, non-credit of Allotted Equity Shares in the respective beneficiary account, non-receipt of refund orders or non-receipt of funds by electronic mode, etc. For all Offer related queries and for redressal of complaints, investors may also write to the BRLMs.

AVAILABILITY OF THE RHP: Investors are advised to refer to the RHP and the “Risk Factors” beginning on page 21 of the RHP before applying in the Offer. A copy of the RHP will be made available on the website of SEBI at www.sebi.gov.in and is available on the websites of the BRLMs, ICICI Securities Limited at www.icicisecurities.com, DAM Capital Securities Limited at www.damcapital.in and JM Financial Limited at www.jmfl.com and at the website of our Company, HERO MOTORS LIMITED at www.heromotors.com and the websites of the Stock Exchanges, for BSE Limited at www.bseindia.com and for National Stock Exchange of India Limited at www.nseindia.com.

AVAILABILITY OF THE ABRIDGED PROSPECTUS: A copy of the Abridged Prospectus shall be available on the website of the Company, the BRLMs and the Registrar to the Offer at: www.heromotors.com, www.icicisecurities.com, www.damcapital.in, www.jmfl.com and www.kfintech.com, respectively.

AVAILABILITY OF BID CUM APPLICATION FORM: Bid cum Application Form can be obtained from the Registered Office of our Company, HERO MOTORS LIMITED, Telephone: +91 120 4412 000. BRLMs: ICICI Securities Limited, Tel: +91 22 6807 7100; DAM Capital Advisors Limited, Tel: +91 22 4202 2500 and JM Financial Limited, Tel: +91 22 6630 3030 and Syndicate Members: Sharekhan Limited, Telephone Number: +91 22 6750 2000, and JM Financial Services Limited, Telephone Number: +91 22 6136 3400, registered Brokers, SCSBs, Designated RTA Locations and Designated CDP Locations for participating in the Offer. Bid cum Application Forms will also be available on the websites of the Stock Exchanges at www.bseindia.com and www.nseindia.com and at all the Designated Branches of SCSBs, the list of which is available on the websites of the Stock Exchanges and SEBI.

APPLICATIONS SUPPORTED BY BLOCKED AMOUNT (ASBA): Investors have to apply through the ASBA process. ASBA has to be availed by all the investors. For details on ASBA process, please refer to the details given in the ASBA Form and Abridged Prospectus and also please refer to “Offer Procedure” on page 513 of the RHP. Further ASBA Application forms can be obtained from Designated Branches of SCSBs, the list of banks that are available on website of SEBI at www.sebi.gov.in and website of Stock Exchanges at www.nseindia.com and www.bseindia.com. The investors are required to fill the Bid cum Application Form and submit the same to the relevant SCSBs at the specific locations or registered brokers at the broker centers or RTA or DP’s. The SCSB’s will block the amount in the account as per the authority contained in application form. On allotment, amount will be unblocked and account will be debited only to the extent required to be paid for allotment of shares. Hence, there will be no need of refund.

HERO MOTORS LIMITED is proposing, subject to receipt of requisite approvals, market conditions and other considerations, an initial public offer of its Equity Shares and has filed a RHP dated September 9, 2026 with the RoC. The RHP is made available on the website of the SEBI at www.sebi.gov.in as well as on the website of the BRLMs i.e., ICICI Securities Limited at : www.icicisecurities.com, DAM Capital Advisors Limited at www.damcapital.in and JM Financial Limited at www.jmfl.com, the website of the NSE at www.nseindia.com and the website of the BSE at www.bseindia.com and the website of the Company at www.heromotors.com. Any potential investor should note that investment in equity shares involves a high degree of risk and should refer to the RHP, including the section titled “Risk Factors” beginning on page 21 of the RHP. Potential investors should not rely on the DRHP for making any investment decision

This announcement does not constitute an invitation or offer of securities for sale in any jurisdiction. The Equity Shares have not been, and will not be, registered under the United States Securities Act of 1933, as amended (“U.S. Securities Act”) or any state securities laws in the United States, and unless so registered, may not be offered or sold within the United States, except pursuant to an exemption from, or in a transaction not subject to, the registration requirements of the U.S. Securities Act and applicable U.S. state securities laws. Accordingly, the Equity Shares are being offered and sold only outside the United States, in “offshore transactions”, as defined in and in reliance on Regulation S under the U.S. Securities Act and the applicable laws of the jurisdictions in which such offers and sales are made. There will be no public offering in the United States.

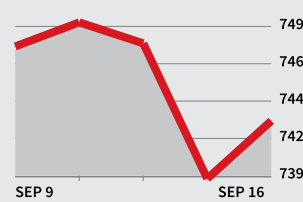
For HERO MOTORS LIMITED
On behalf of the Board of Directors

Sd/-
Sakshi Dureja
Company Secretary and Compliance Officer

Place: Noida, Uttar Pradesh
Date: September 16, 2026

the hindu businessline

SENSEX 74336.45 (+332.63)



IN FOCUS

	LATEST	CHANGE
Nifty 50	23217.60	+99.00
P/E Ratio (Sensex)	19.69	+0.09
US Dollar (in ₹)	95.95	--
Gold Std 10 gm (in ₹)	151752.00	+1454
Silver 1 kg (in ₹)	231337.00	+2596

NON-TARIFF BARRIERS?

China cancels licences of three more Indian rice exporters over alleged GMO presence p10



TECHNOPHILE.

Is Apple's boldest iPhone since 2007 redefining smartphones or is it merely a premium indulgence? p4

BENGALURU - CHENNAI - COIMBATORE - HUBBALLI - HYDERABAD - KOCHI - KOLKATA - MADURAI - MALAPPURAM - MANGALURU - MUMBAI - NOIDA - THIRUVANANTHAPURAM - TIRUCHIRAPPALLI - VIJAYAWADA - VISAKHAPATNAM

Regd. TN/ARD/14/2012-2014, RNI No. 55320/94

QUICKLY.

RUN-UP TO IPO

NSE raises ₹6,746 crore from anchor investors

Mumbai: The NSE has raised ₹6,746.18 crore from anchor investors ahead of its IPO, with LIC, Government Pension Fund Global, Monetary Authority of Singapore and several large domestic mutual funds among the investors. The NSE allotted 3.78 crore shares to anchor investors at ₹1,785 per share, with LIC receiving the largest allocation at ₹450.3 crore, followed by Government Pension Fund Global at ₹249.99 crore and Monetary Authority of Singapore at ₹199.99 crore. **p8**

INDIA TRUST TEST

Meta's personal AI agent 'Muse' to face scrutiny

Chennai: Even as Meta's new personal intelligence tool Muse takes AI to the next level — from answering queries to completing tasks — experts say the technology's biggest test will be its ability to act on the users' behalf without compromising their data or triggering unauthorised transactions. The potential of Muse is closely linked to the safeguards governing its autonomy and its rollout in India will require a clear governance framework, said analysts. **p12**

India faces 100% tariff if US House passes sanctions Bill

KEY VOTE. Delhi tracking moves; new law will empower Trump to impose or waive levy

Amiti Sen
New Delhi

The US House of Representatives is set to vote on the Lindsey O Graham Sanctioning Russia and Iran Act of 2026 on Wednesday which, if passed and signed into law by US President Donald Trump, could give him the authority to impose tariffs of up to 100 per cent on major buyers of Russian energy. India is potentially exposed as it is the second largest buyer of Russian oil.

India's response would also depend on how Trump executes the law, once formulated, as it allows him to decide if and when to slap tariffs of up to 100 per cent on the five top importers of Russian oil and gas (which would include both China and India), a source tracking the matter said.

Trump could also waive the tariffs if he so chooses, by claiming it helps national interest.

'NO POLICY SHIFT'

New Delhi has already sig-



PUNITIVE POWERS. If the Bill becomes law, US President Donald Trump can impose tariffs of up to 100 per cent on countries buying Russian energy **p11**

nalled no shift in its energy-sourcing strategy despite the looming tariff threat. Responding to a question on the Lindsey Graham Bill at Tuesday's media briefing, MEA spokesperson Randhir Jaiswal said New Delhi's energy sourcing decisions "are based on our national interest", reiterating that this calculus remains unchanged.

CRUDE IMPORTS

Russia supplied 30.3 per cent of India's crude imports in FY26 — worth \$40.8 billion out of the total crude imports of \$134.7 billion. In July, Moscow accounted for

more than half of India's oil imports. On Monday, the Rules Committee voted 7-3 to advance the Bill. The Rules Committee rejected two Democratic amendments that sought to identify the countries that could face the tariffs and remove the broad secondary tariff provision altogether.

The first amendment, moved by Congressman Steny Hoyer, would have explicitly named 10 countries, including India, China, Türkiye, the UAE and Singapore, as eligible for tariffs up to 100 per cent for buying Russian crude or gas or aid-

ing sanctions evasion. It was defeated 3-7.

However, this offers India no relief as a second, more significant, amendment from Congressman Gregory Meeks, seeking to strike the President's broad secondary-tariff authority, was also defeated 3-7.

PRESIDENT'S POWERS

As a result, if the Bill becomes law, President Trump would retain the power to impose tariffs. The Senate-passed Bill names no country; tariffs are triggered based on a country ranking among the five largest importers of Russian oil/gas by volume.

For India, this creates a fresh tariff risk at a time when New Delhi has been negotiating a bilateral trade agreement (BTA) with Washington and has maintained that its Russian oil purchases are driven by energy-security considerations, noted Ajay Srivastava from research body GTRI. "The Bill is a blunt and dangerous attempt to pressurise India to sign the one-sided BTA," he said. **Details p3**

8 crore workers assured of higher savings with EPFO wage cap raised to ₹25,000

Dalip Singh
New Delhi

The Union Cabinet on Wednesday approved raising the EPFO (Employees' Provident Fund Organisation) wage ceiling from ₹15,000 to ₹25,000 per month, ensuring that 7.98 crore subscribing workers have mandatory higher savings and enhanced social security protection from Thursday.

The announcement will effectively result in monthly Provident Fund (PF) contributions for employees going up from the existing ₹1,800 to ₹3,000.

The EPFO wage ceiling acts as the statutory limit on an employee's salary base for mandatory PF and Pension (EPS) contributions. The basic salary plus dearness allowance makes for PF wage.

WAGE GROWTH

The EPFO wage ceiling remained unchanged throughout the decade from 2004 to 2014, before being substantially enhanced to ₹15,000 in September 2014.

Further raising of the ceiling to ₹25,000 reflects sustained wage growth, rising incomes and a continued expansion of formal employ-

SAVINGS BOOST

- Covers 7.98 crore EPFO subscribing workers
- Boosts PF, pension, EDLI insurance protection
- Move ensures parity with rising wages

ment over the intervening years, the government said in a statement.

Union Minister for Labour and Employment Mansukh Mandaviya said the move aims to bring nationwide parity since minimum wages of workers in many States have jumped over the years to ₹15,000 and more per month and, at the same time, the average salary in the private sector, too, hovers around ₹23,000 per month.

Henceforth, the average monthly contribution of an employer towards EPF will go up to ₹600, the Minister explained. The annual government outgo is estimated at about ₹11,339 crore, against the existing annual budgetary support of about ₹10,250 crore. The estimated expenditure over five years is approximately ₹56,696 crore.

At board meet, Tata Trusts may ask Tata Sons to seek RBI clarity on NBFC plea rejection

Aneesh Phadnis
Mumbai

Tata Trusts may ask Tata Sons to seek clarity from the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) regarding its continued inclusion in the Non-Banking Financial Company-Upper Layer list.

Last Friday, the RBI rejected Tata Sons' plea for declassification as an unregistered core investment company, thereby triggering the requirement to list its shares to comply with regulatory norms.

BOARD MEETING

The issue of whether to comply with the RBI directive or challenge the decision is expected to be discussed at the Tata Sons board meeting on Thursday.

A person close to the Tata Trusts said the one-page letter addressed to Tata Sons



Tata Trusts Chairman
Noel Tata

Chief Financial Officer Saurabh Agrawal provides no reasoning or explanation for the RBI's decision.

The Trusts may ask Tata Sons to seek such a clarification before pursuing the next steps.

MAJORITY STAKES

Tata Trusts own a 66 per cent stake in Tata Sons, making them the largest shareholder

of the conglomerate's holding company.

The issue of listing the company's shares has divided shareholders, with the Shapoorji Pallonji (SP) Group favouring a share sale as a means of unlocking liquidity. The SP Group holds more than 18 per cent stake in Tata Sons.

Two key trusts, the Sir Dorabji Tata Trust and the Sir Ratan Tata Trust, together control 52 per cent of Tata Sons' shares.

PUBLIC SCRUTINY

Tata Trusts Chairman Noel Tata is opposed to a share sale that would bring the group holding company under public scrutiny. He is expected to reiterate this position at the Tata Sons board meeting.

The Trusts had last year passed a resolution asking Tata Sons to engage with the RBI in an effort to ensure

that the company remains privately held. Two trustees, Vijay Singh and Venu Srinivasan, however, have publicly voiced support for a listing. Srinivasan is also a member of the Tata Sons board.

EXPANSION PLANS

Their contention is that a listing would benefit the Group, which requires capital to support its expansion plans and investment in new businesses and sectors.

The board meeting is the first since Chairman N Chandrasekaran announced last month that he would not seek a third term after February 2027.

While the official agenda for the meeting is to finalise the first-quarter financial results, issues related to the RBI's letter and the Group's leadership transition are also expected to figure prominently in discussions.

Paid for a service, MDR can 'qualify as a tax-deductible business expenditure'

Shishir Sinha
New Delhi

The Merchant Discount Rate (MDR) fee on UPI transactions can be considered a tax-deductible business expense. Experts say there is legal backing to treat such charges as business expenses.

Based on an FAQ by NPCI, a merchant accepting a digital payment will need to pay a certain sum to banks and payment service providers for processing a digital payment.

The question then arises: As this payout is in furtherance of business, should this be treated as a business income for income tax purpose? Section 34 of the Income Tax Act, 2025, governs general business expendi-

ture deductions. The provision provides that expenses laid out completely for business or professional purposes are allowed when computing profits and gains. Based on this, experts say the MDR can be considered a business expense.

NOT A TAX OR LEVY

According to Deepesh Chheda, Partner at Dhruva Advisor, MDR works much like the fees that businesses already pay for accepting card payments or using online payment gateways. It is not a government tax or duty, and that distinction matters because taxes and duties are often not deductible.

"Since the MDR is paid to a bank for a service, not to the government as a tax, it should normally qualify as an

LEGALLY SOUND

- Merchants can claim MDR as a tax deduction
- NPCI says payout furthers business operations
- Deduction can lower effective MDR cost significantly

ordinary, deductible business expense, just like rent, salary or other regular costs of doing business," he said.

Richa Mishra, Partner at Grant Thornton Bharat, said that from a taxation perspective, the MDR is comparable to other transaction processing and banking charges incurred in the ordinary course of business.

"Its close nexus with busi-

ness operations supports the view that it should ordinarily qualify as a deductible business expenditure under the general deduction provisions," she said.

EFFECTIVE COST

Vishal Gada, Founder and CEO of Aurtus, said since the deduction reduces taxable profits, the effective cost of the MDR falls by the applicable tax rate. For example, "a company taxed at about 25 per cent would bear only around three-fourths of the MDR in real terms," he said.

Rahul Jain, Partner at Khaitan & Co, said similar bank fees or payment collection or realisation charges have been treated as tax deductible in the past and hence, "this is a settled position in law".

More reports p2

Sabse Pehle
Life Insurance

New Labour Codes have redefined Employer obligations on Gratuity and Leave Encashment.

Our expertise will ensure the compliance becomes Simple, Reliable, and Future - ready.

Presenting

LIC's GROUP SCHEMES

- New Group Gratuity Cash Accumulation Plan - UIN: 512N281V04**
- New Group Leave Encashment Plan - UIN: 512N282V04**
- New Group Superannuation Cash Accumulation Plan - UIN: 512N274V03**
- Group Post Retirement Medical Benefit Scheme - UIN: 512N352V01**
- Group Benefits Secure Plan - UIN: 512N367V01**

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- Attractive Returns
- Benefit of insurance protection
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MDR reset puts digital payment economics, competition under lens

THE COUNTEREFFECT. Zero fees helped UPI scale but it could make the ecosystem less competitive: Experts

Jyoti Banthia
Bengaluru

The National Payments Corporation of India's (NPCI) decision to introduce a 0.4 per cent Merchant Discount Rate (MDR) on select UPI merchant transactions above ₹2,000 is set to alter the economics of India's digital payments ecosystem, with payment service providers (PSPs), banks and fintechs assessing how the new framework could affect their operating models.

Under the framework, MDR will apply to select person-to-merchant (P2M) transactions, while consumer payments and P2P transactions remain free. Transactions of ₹75,000 and above will have an MDR cap of ₹300, while lower rates will apply to certain categories.

COST DISTRIBUTION
The bigger question for the industry is how the costs and interchange will be distributed across the ecosystem, particularly among PSPs, UPI apps, issuing banks, payment aggregators and acquiring banks. PSPs have played a key role in expanding the adoption of UPI and merchant acceptance in the country, while also bearing significant technology and operational costs. "Scaling UPI to its current national footprint has been a collective effort across the entire payments ecosystem, requiring deep collaboration between third-party application providers (TPAPs), PSPs, issuing banks to scale consumer adoption and payment aggregators and acquiring banks to grow



PULLING THEIR WEIGHT. Payment-service providers played a key role in expanding UPI adoption and merchant acceptance in India, while bearing technology and operational costs

the acceptance network," said a PhonePe spokesperson. The company said NPCI had established a balanced framework through the MDR cap and interchange distribution, ensuring different participants are recognised for their role in sustaining the network. **IMPACT ON OPERATORS** PhonePe said it was too early to quantify the precise financial impact because of variables including industry-specific programmes, flat-fee structures for some segments and the transaction mix. However, it said the framework will help offset some of the costs operators incur on both the consumer and merchant sides. "Operating an enterprise-grade payments platform requires continuous investments in critical operations, including high-uptime technology infrastructure, cus-

tomers support, grievance redressal, risk and fraud detection systems, and advanced cybersecurity pre-

paredness," the spokesperson added. Industry experts said the move also needs to be viewed through the lens of competition. Paramdeep Singh, Founder of venture-capital firm Long Tail Ventures, said zero MDR had helped UPI scale but it could eventually make the ecosystem less competitive because larger fintechs and banks could absorb payment-processing costs more easily than newer entrants. **MERCHANT IMPACT** "A limited MDR" need not run contrary to UPI's original objective, said Singh, as consumers continue to pay nothing, P2P remains free and smaller merchants are largely protected. Kunal Jhunjhunwala, Founder of financial-services

platform airpay, said fintechs had invested heavily in taking digital payments to merchant segments and that their contribution should be recognised in the way the model is structured. He also flagged the adjustment required from merchants, particularly those operating on thin margins. Decentro Founder and CEO Rohit Taneja said the selective MDR creates a path towards a more sustainable ecosystem while protecting consumers and small merchants. The next phase, therefore, will be less about whether UPI can sustain its scale and more about whether its economics allow the banks, PSPs, and fintechs supporting that scale to keep investing in infrastructure, security, and merchant acceptance.

No foreign influence behind decision: FinMin

Press Trust of India
New Delhi

The Finance Ministry on Wednesday clarified that there was no foreign influence behind the decision to impose 0.4 per cent Merchant Discount Rate (MDR) on UPI transactions above ₹2,000. The clarification follows accusations by some Opposition parties, including the Congress, that the government succumbed to the US' pressure in taking the decision. "Some claims suggest the change is due to foreign influence. This is false. India's UPI policy decisions are made independently, with the clear

goal of building a self-sustaining, inclusive, and affordable digital payments ecosystem," the Ministry said in a post on X. UPI processed 24.5 billion transactions in August 2026 alone. To keep this system self-sustainable, secure and innovative, a small fee on high-value merchant transactions helps fund better infrastructure, cybersecurity and support for small merchants in tier 3-6 towns, the post said. The new framework ensures resources from higher-value merchant transactions are reinvested to support small businesses and strengthen digital payments across the country, it added.

The ministry clarified that MDR is neither a tax nor a charge collected by the government or the NPCI. It is distributed among payment ecosystem participants, including banks and payment service providers. The NPCI, which operates the UPI network, said the revenue will support investment in infrastructure resilience, cybersecurity, fraud prevention, innovation and customer service. **NO RETHINK** Earlier during the day, a top government official said there was no question of a re-think on the issue of the imposition of MDR.

Fuel retailers seek MDR exemption

Ground reality

Daily MDR cost by outlet type

	Number of daily UPI transactions	Number of transactions above ₹2,000	Daily MDR cost
Urban	250-400	12-18%	₹150-350
Semi-urban	300-500	18-25%	₹300-600
Highway	400-700+	25-40%	₹500-1,400
National average	—	₹20%	₹230-250

Retail outlets as of July 31, 2026 - 1,04,069 MDR: Merchant Discount Rate Hemant Sirohi, Member of Empower Petroleum Dealers Foundation

Rishi Ranjan Kala
New Delhi

Fuel retailers and petrol pump operators have urged the government to exempt petrol and diesel purchases of above ₹2,000 from a flat Merchant Discount Rate (MDR) of ₹5 per transaction. The dealers said they already operate on thin margins and will be forced to stop accepting UPI payments of ₹2,000 and above. "With wafer-thin margins, not revised in line with inflation since 2017, it is very difficult for dealers to incur any such charges," said Monty Sehgal of the Federation of All India Petroleum Traders.

WHAT CAN BE DONE
"I am thankful to the government that it has capped the MDR... In the past, the MDR of credit and debit cards was being absorbed by oil marketing companies (OMCs). A similar arrangement can be made or the dealer margin should be increased adequately to absorb the MDR cost," said Hemant Sirohi, Member of Empower Petroleum Dealers Foundation. Sirohi said transactions above ₹2,000 make up around 20 per cent of all transactions at India's over

1.06 lakh retail outlets. Roughly 23.9 million UPI transactions happen across them every month, per NPCI data. Their value comes to around ₹1,573 per day. With one-fifth of them being above ₹2,000, the daily MDR comes to about ₹2.4 crore, he added. "This is an average. Dealer margin for petrol is ₹3.4-3.7 per litre and for diesel it is ₹2.4-2.7." **'NEED PROTECTION'** The association representing petroleum traders in Karnataka, AKFPT, also expressed concerns over charging MDR on certain merchant transactions. "Petroleum retail outlets cannot be compared with ordinary retail businesses. The selling prices of petrol and diesel are determined by the respective OMCs, and dealers operate on a prescribed commission and margin structure," KM Basavegowda, President of AKFPT, wrote to Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman and Oil Minister Hardeep Singh Puri. "A dealer does not have the freedom to increase the retail selling price of petrol or diesel merely because the cost of accepting a particular digital-payment mode increases." He added that during the post-demonetisation period, dealers supported the government in promoting cashless transactions. The government exempted them from MDR charges then, absorbed by OMCs. "This constitutes a clear and important policy precedent. AKFPT respectfully submits that the same principle be applied to any proposed MDR framework in 2026," he urged.

PIL in Supreme Court challenges UPI fee

Press Trust of India
New Delhi

A public interest litigation (PIL) matter has been filed in the Supreme Court, challenging the Centre's decision to impose a merchant discount rate (MDR) on specified UPI person-to-merchant transactions of above ₹2,000. The PIL, filed by advocate Anjan Datta, said the levy had been introduced without adequate statutory safeguards, transparency or public consultation.

QUESTIONS RAISED
The petitioner challenged the constitutional validity of the amended section 10A of the Payment and Settlement Systems Act, 2007, alleging that it gives unguided powers to the executive to decide which electronic payment modes would receive the no-charge protection. It further questioned the fixation of the rates, transaction thresholds, caps and

sectoral classifications through what the petitioner describes as a press release, alleging that the complete operative instrument prescribing these charges has not been published in the Official Gazette. The petitioner also questioned the distinction between UPI transactions and RuPay debit-card payments, pointing out that the notification continues the no-charge protection for RuPay debit cards without a monetary ceiling. The plea alleged that the framework is arbitrary and discriminatory, and may adversely affect merchants, particularly those with low margins, while also raising concerns over possible indirect consumer burden and digital exclusion. While seeking a quashing or suspension of the framework, the plea also sought a reconsideration of the framework after transparent consultation, publication of empirical data and an impact assessment.

Retailers, clothing manufacturers flag impact on MSMEs

Meenakshi Verma Ambwani
New Delhi

The Retailers Association of India (RAI) and the Clothing Manufacturers Association of India (CMAI) on Wednesday expressed concern over the government's decision to introduce a 0.4 per cent Merchant Discount Rate (MDR) on UPI just ahead of the festival season. In fact, RAI has called for a graded structure that separates debit-linked UPI transactions from credit-linked ones and pairs any merchant charge with incentives to ensure that small retailers remain in the formal payment system. It said it will take up the matter with the National Payments Corporation of India (NPCI) and the Ministry of Finance.

The development comes at the start of the festival season, a critical period for merchants, retailers and consumer-facing businesses, many of whom are already working hard to revive demand and improve margins, said Santosh Katariya, President, CMAI. "Adding another cost to digital transactions at this juncture risks putting further pressure on an ecosystem that is still finding its footing." The RAI, meanwhile, has



THE COST. RAI's Rajagopalan said the shift back to cash would hurt the government's own formalisation push

son, a large share of transactions crosses the ₹2,000 mark, and the moment a fee attaches itself to digital payment, cash becomes the path of least resistance," said Kumar Rajagopalan, Chief Executive Officer, RAI. UPI acceptance should be incentivised, not taxed, he said. "We don't see the case for charging a bank-to-bank UPI payment the way you'd charge for credit. Where UPI is linked to a credit line, a fee is easier to defend, because the cost structure genuinely resembles a credit product. We urge that the government bear the cost of normal UPI transactions," said Rajagopalan, adding that these traceable transactions make a formal trail that feeds GST reporting. "The NPCI keeps UPI running for the entire country; the RBI or the government should be underwriting that cost, not merchants," Rajagopalan said.

warned that the charge could undo years of progress that small retailers have done in adopting digital payments. The framework keeps consumers outside its ambit, but the burden still lands on merchants, it noted. "Small merchants will now think twice about whether to accept cash or UPI. During the festival sea-

VISUALLY.

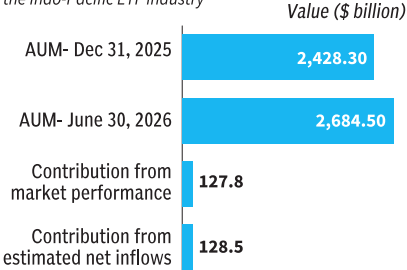
Compiled by Yashaswani Chauhan | Graphic: Visveswaran V

Indo-Pacific ETF flows hit record highs, led by Taiwan, South Korea

The Indo-Pacific ETF industry attracted a record \$128.5 billion in estimated net inflows in the first half of 2026, taking assets under management to \$2.68 trillion by June-end. The Indo-Pacific ETF Industry Review H1 2026 by LSEG Data & Analytics shows that equity ETFs accounted for the bulk of fresh inflows, while South Korea emerged as the biggest ETF domicile by new money

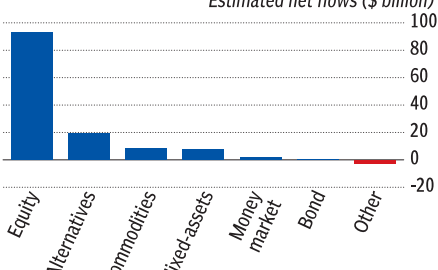
ETF assets rise \$256 billion in six months

Assets under management in the Indo-Pacific ETF industry



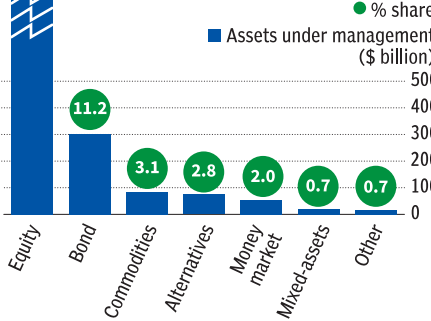
Equity ETFs capture \$93.4 billion of new money

Estimated net ETF flows by asset type, H1 2026



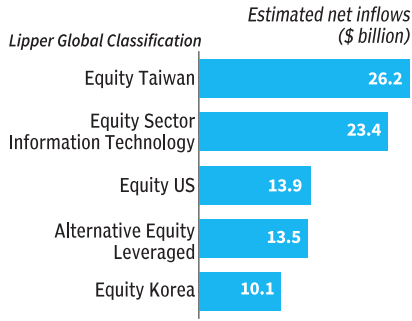
Equities dominate the \$2.68 trillion ETF market

Indo-Pacific ETF assets by asset type, June 2026



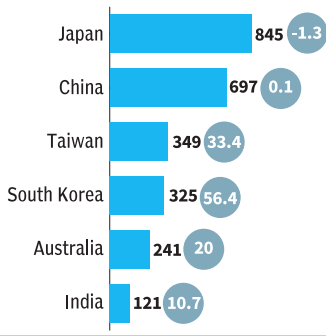
Taiwan and technology ETFs lead investor demand

Top ETF classifications by estimated net inflows, H1 2026



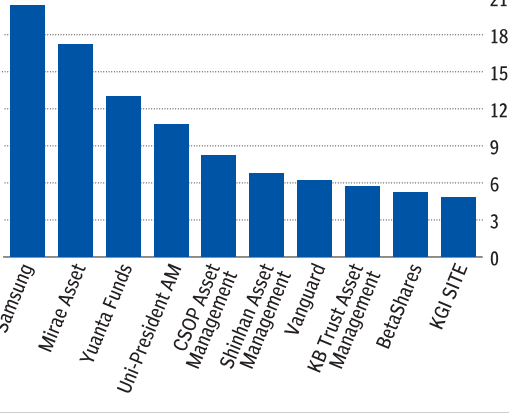
Japan ETFs hold the most assets, but investors pulled money out

ETF assets and flows by major domicile



Samsung leads ETF promoters as top 10 attract \$98.2 billion

Top ETF promoters by estimated net inflows, H1 2026



Source: Indo-Pacific ETF Industry Review H1 2026 by LSEG Data & Analytics

'Need clarity on client-broker transfers'

Akshata Gorde
Mumbai

The proposed 0.02 per cent merchant discount rate (MDR) on UPI transactions in the capital markets could create an unintended cost for stock brokers, as the charge may apply even when clients merely transfer their own money into their broking accounts and do not execute a trade.

Brokers said such transfers are essentially the movement of a client's own funds and do not represent a commercial transaction that generates revenue.

"The fundamental issue is that there should be no MDR on a client transferring funds to their own broking account. This is merely a movement of their own money for the purpose of investing or trading and does not represent a commercial transaction," said Ajay Kejriwal, Director at Choice Broking.

"Charging the broker 0.02 per cent on such transfers, including cases where the



THE LOGIC. Industry stakeholders say clients could transfer funds to their own accounts for investing or trading, and this does not represent a commercial transaction by the broker ANI

client ultimately does not execute a trade, creates a cost without any corresponding brokerage revenue," he said.

'NO GUARANTEE'
Zerodha Founder and CEO Nithin Kamath said there is no guarantee that the money transferred to a broker would result in a transaction, while brokers could not force clients to trade after transferring funds. For instance, 10,000 customers making 50 UPI transfers of ₹2 lakh each in a month, without execut-

ing a single trade, could potentially result in a UPI cost of around ₹2 crore for the broker at the proposed MDR. Clients routinely move funds into their trading accounts and more than half of such fund transfers after quarterly settlements happen through UPI, potentially creating a recurring cost for brokers without generating additional revenue, he said. The impact could be more pronounced for discount brokers, where brokerage on some transactions is already

very low or nil. "As passing this charge to clients is not an option, and discount-brokerage brokerage can itself be lower than the MDR, absorption would directly impact margins and could adversely affect low-cost offerings," Kejriwal said. He said the ₹300 cap does not address the fundamental concern and that the government may need to clarify the treatment of transfers into a client's own broking account. Kamath said an MDR itself was not necessarily an issue, but said a much lower cap of ₹5-10 per transaction would be more reasonable.

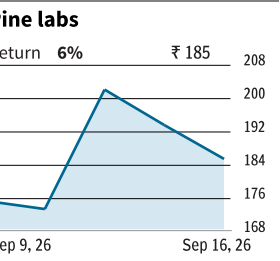
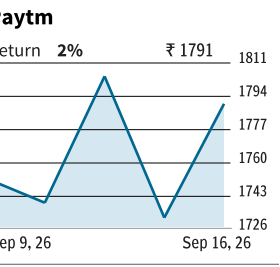
LIMITED IMPACT
For retail investors, however, HDFC Securities MD and CEO Dhiraj Relli said the impact should remain limited. The rate is significantly lower than the standard MDR, while UPI-based SIP payments through AutoPay would fall outside the framework. One-time transfers, he said, would carry a cost of only a few rupees in most cases.

Paytm up 3.5%; Pine Labs, One Mobikwik pare gains

Press Trust of India
New Delhi

Shares of fintech firms Paytm and Network People Services Technologies rallied on Wednesday after the government introduced a 0.4 per cent fee on UPI transfers worth more than ₹2,000 made to merchants from October 15.

The stock of One97 Communications Ltd, which owns the Paytm brand, jumped 7.24 per cent intraday to reach the 52-week high of ₹1,856.50 on the BSE. It ended at ₹1,791.70, up 3.50 per cent. Network People Services Technologies Ltd surged 12.27 per cent. Shares of One Mobikwik Systems Ltd climbed 5.96 per cent and Pine Labs edged higher by 2.68 per cent during the day. The latter, how-



ever, pared all early gains and ended 4.28 per cent lower. One Mobikwik Systems also lost the winning momentum and dipped 1.61 per cent.

QUICKLY.

Juniper Hotels buys Novotel Imagicaa for ₹248 crore

Mumbai: Juniper Hotels Ltd on Wednesday announced a proposed acquisition of Novotel Imagicaa, an operating hotel in Khopoli, Maharashtra, from Imagicaa world Entertainment Ltd (formerly Adlabs Entertainment Ltd) for ₹248 crore, or approximately ₹86 lakh per key. The board approved the deal and a related MoU at its meeting held on Wednesday. The transaction is a straight cash deal with no share issuance involved and is not classified as a related-party transaction. The hotel sits on approximately 11 acres near Khopoli in Raigad district, within a two-hour drive from Mumbai. It has a built-up area of around 2,80,000 sq/ft and it comprises 287 guest rooms, along with restaurants, banquet halls, meeting facilities, a spa, and recreational amenities. Juniper said the acquisition fits its strategy of building a portfolio of large hotels in key business and leisure markets. **OUR BUREAU**

Samsung India eyes double-digit growth in H2 on festival demand

SIGNIFICANT SHIFT. Rising aspirations drive Indian consumers toward premium segment over economy

Meenakshi Verma Ambwani
New Delhi

Samsung India expects its home appliance business to garner double-digit growth in the second half of the year, driven by strong festival demand and expansion of the premium segment.

STRONG DEMAND
Ghufran Alam, Vice-President, Digital Appliances Business, Samsung India, said, “During Onam, which marks the start of the festival season, we have seen quite high

The economy segment is not declining, but the growth is faster in the premium and mid-tier segments

GHUFRAN ALAM
Vice-President, Digital Appliances Business, Samsung India



double-digit growth. The expansion of the premium segment has continued this year, and there is momentum in the adoption of AI-enabled appliances. Looking at these robust demand trends during the Independence Day sales period and Onam, we expect this momentum to continue and expect to see

double-digit growth in H2 CY2026.”

GROWTH DRIVERS
After witnessing strong traction for cooling products in the first half of the year, the consumer durables major expects room air-conditioners to continue to be the fastest-growing category, followed

by washing machines and refrigerators in the second half of the year.

Alam added that growth in the mid- and premium-tier segments is outpacing that of the economy segment, as consumers seek to upgrade their appliances amidst rising aspirations.

“The economy segment is not declining, but growth is faster in the premium and mid-tier segments. The key reason is that consumers are upgrading their appliances across regions, whether in rural or urban areas,” he said. He noted that attractive financing schemes are also supporting the trend toward premiumisation.

PRICING STRATEGY
Asked if the company will take price hikes to mitigate

the recent increase seen in commodity costs such as copper and plastics, Alam said, “We look at the market situation, and sometimes we have to do price calibrations. It is not a kind of one-time exercise. Whether we are going to increase the price before festival season, we don't know currently because it's all very dynamic.”

UPGRADE TREND
Within the refrigerator category, the French door (four-door) and side-by-side segments are witnessing strong growth, particularly in capacities of 450 litres and above, said Alam. In washing machines, consumers are increasingly upgrading to higher-capacity models of 10-14 kg across both front-load and top-load categories.

‘US tariff threat pushes India Inc to new markets as cost gap narrows to 8%’

Amit Vijay Mohile
Maresh Ravidas Nayak
Mumbai

A fresh US threat of tariffs of up to 100 per cent on India over its purchases of Russian oil has raised the stakes for Corporate India's search for new markets.

At the same time, improvements in infrastructure, power, and logistics have narrowed the country's cost disadvantage to about 8 per cent from roughly 12 per cent.

“We do favour market diversification and also product and tariff-line diversification,” CII President and MD and CEO of Tata Chemicals, R Mukundan, told *businessline*, describing how companies have responded to earlier tariff disruptions.

Even where India already has free-trade agreements, companies may be using only 30-40 per cent of available tariff lines, Mukundan said, leaving considerable room to extract more business from market access already negotiated.

REDRAWING TRADE MAP
That hunt is widening as India pursues trade negotiations with the Gulf Cooperation Council (GCC), Israel and Peru, while deepening engagement with Mexico and Chile.

Mukundan said signing agreements is only part of the job; industry must translate them into tangible business opportunities.

“One is at a policy level, to make our industry more competitive,” he said of CII's role. Next steps include giving companies access and



R Mukundan, CII President and MD & CEO of Tata Chemicals

partnerships in individual markets and creating direct company-to-company connections between buyers and sellers. Supply chains are part of that equation.

On Agratas, the Tata Group's battery company building cell-manufacturing capacity for Tata Motors and Jaguar Land Rover, Mukundan said Tata Group companies were working to-

gether as one team, while stressing that battery solutions ultimately have to be competitive on both cost and technology.

Asked specifically whether the Agratas project was on schedule, Mukundan declined to comment on its timeline but said the project was being executed “as expeditiously as possible”.

India's wider battery build-out, he said, will also require partnerships for upstream resources, pointing to Australia, Chile and Argentina, while Indian companies will need to work with larger global technology players as domestic battery manufacturing scales up.

India's battery push will also require resource partnerships. “You will have to work with partner countries,” Mukundan said, pointing to “Australia, Chile

and Argentina” as potential partners for upstream resources.

“We have to now move from intent to outcomes,” Mukundan said of BRICS+.

“How does it lead to greater business in terms of trade? How does it lead to greater business in terms of cross-border investment plus technology and people access?” he said.

That requires tackling barriers beyond tariffs, including differences in quality standards, testing and documentation, while connecting buyers and suppliers.

“Sometimes getting investment into promoting trade may be the right route to follow,” Mukundan said.

Europe offers another avenue, with country- and sector-specific partnerships in engineering, electronics, specialty chemicals and ad-

vanced manufacturing technologies.

SPEED MATTERS
“The infrastructure piece has started to deliver,” Mukundan said, estimating that India's cost differential has narrowed from roughly 12 per cent to about 8 per cent as improvements in power and logistics continue to take effect.

Faster execution could provide another offset. “If we can compress the execution [time] to two-thirds of what it is today,” Mukundan said, “that time reduction can take care of all the interest cost and other costs”.

Industry, he added, has been asking the government to benchmark each process individually, understand how long each stage takes, and reduce cycle times accordingly.

Q-comm gets a festival boost as Ganesh Chaturthi drives demand for idols, *modaks*

Our Bureau
Bengaluru

Quick-commerce platforms saw a sharp rise in demand for festive essentials during Ganesh Chaturthi, as consumers increasingly turned to online platforms for everything from idols and flowers to puja supplies and sweets.

Swiggy Instamart reported a 176 per cent year-on-year jump in demand for eco-friendly clay idols during the festival. Ready-to-place clay idols accounted for 90 per cent of demand, while paint-your-own eco idols made up the remainder.

SURGING DEMAND

The trend was particularly pronounced outside traditional Ganesh Chaturthi markets. Delhi recorded a 1,718 per cent increase in eco-Ganpati orders, followed by Kolkata at 1,305 per



SWEET TREND. *Modaks* emerged as a major category. *Mawa* was the most-ordered flavour on Instamart, with demand rising 145% on year, followed by kesar, kaju, assorted and amba variants

cent, Noida at 1,136 per cent and Bhubaneswar at 1,132 per cent.

Modaks also emerged as a major festive category. *Mawa* was the most-ordered flavour on Instamart, with demand rising 145 per cent year-on-year, followed by *kesar*, *kaju*, assorted and amba variants. *Mawa* led demand in Bengaluru, Mumbai and Hyderabad, while Delhi

and Gurgaon preferred *kesar*. Pune, Chennai, Kolkata and Nagpur leaned towards classic *modaks*.

The platform also saw distinct peaks in demand through the morning of September 14. Flower orders peaked at 7.42 am at 868 orders a minute, followed by eco-friendly idols at 8.48 am. Puja essentials peaked at 9.45 am, while *modak* orders

reached their highest point at 10.39 am. Flipkart Minutes, meanwhile, reported a 2.5x increase in demand across categories, including decor, puja essentials, ethnic wear, sweets and gifting. Ganesh idol orders rose five-fold, while *modak* demand increased four-fold.

The platform said tier-2 and tier-3 cities such as Patna, Lucknow and Guwahati recorded eight-fold growth in sales during the festival period.

GEN Z LEADS

Gen Z demand grew three-fold, with eco-friendly idols, fruits, flowers and dry fruits among the most-ordered categories.

The data points to quick commerce is increasingly becoming part of consumers' last-minute and routine festival shopping, with the 6 am-11 am window emerging as the busiest period on Flipkart Minutes.

Exide Industries ties up with Germany's ExCom to boost battery exports to Europe

Mithun Dasgupta
Kolkata

Storage battery major Exide Industries is aiming to scale up its industrial battery exports to the European market from this fiscal year, backed by its exclusive arrangement with Germany-based ExCom Energy Solutions.

In a stock exchange filing, Exide said the long-term strategic cooperation agreement with ExCom for industrial batteries and energy storage systems across the European Economic Area (EEA) establishes a strong commercial and strategic collaboration between the two companies.

EUROPEAN REACH

ExCom, which has strong access to the European market, will lead distribution, technical project support, and after-sales coordination in



Avik Roy, MD and CEO, Exide Industries

27 countries in the region. The lead-acid batteries, produced at Exide's plants in India, will be marketed and sold under the ExCom brand.

Exide Industries Managing Director and Chief Executive Officer Avik Roy said the EEA represents a strategically important market for the company, with growing demand for sustainable energy solutions. ExCom GmbH brings strong market access, and proven local execution capabilities. “We aim to create long-term value for

Urban infra to drive India's next growth cycle: NaBFID MD

Maresh Ravidas Nayak
Mumbai

After a decade in which roads and renewable energy transformed India's infrastructure landscape, urban infrastructure is set to become the country's next major investment theme, according to Rajkiran Rai G, Managing Director and CEO of the National Bank for Financing Infrastructure and Development (NaBFID).

Speaking ahead of NaBFID's annual infrastructure conclave, Rai said this year's discussions would focus on mobilising capital for the next phase of growth as India seeks to scale infrastructure investments needed to support its economic ambitions.

The third edition of the conclave marks a shift in focus from earlier editions, which concentrated on fixing project finance challenges and improving the financing ecosystem. Those efforts, Rai said, have helped roads and renewable energy emerge as investable sectors, with the lessons now being applied to newer areas of infrastructure.

URBAN PUSH

“Having got certain sectors right, the question now is where the next phase of investment will come from,” Rai said. India will require infrastructure investments of around ₹170 lakh crore over the next six years, with nearly ₹68 lakh crore needed for urban infrastructure alone, he said. This includes metro rail systems, drinking water projects, sewage treatment, waste management, affordable housing, healthcare and education facilities.

Rai sees urbanisation as the biggest driver of the next investment cycle, with cities expected to account for a growing share of economic activity. However, unlike



Rajkiran Rai G, MD and CEO, NaBFID

roads and renewable energy, financing models for urban projects are still evolving and require stronger participation from capital markets and institutional investors.

A key theme of the conclave will be the liability side of infrastructure finance, particularly how India's expanding pool of insurance, pension and provident fund money can be channelled into long-term infrastructure assets. Rai noted that assets under management across these segments are approaching ₹130 lakh crore and growing steadily, creating a significant source of ‘patient capital’ for infrastructure funding.

India currently spends about ₹20 lakh crore annually on infrastructure, with nearly three-fourths of that investment coming from government-backed institutions. The challenge, Rai said, is to attract large volumes of private and domestic institutional capital to bridge the funding gap.

NEW OPPORTUNITIES

Beyond urban infrastructure, NaBFID sees opportunities emerging in data centres, ports, ship financing, airports, healthcare, education and electric-vehicle charging infrastructure. Data centres are expected to see significant growth as digital demand rises, while healthcare investments are increasing as hospital chains expand into smaller cities.

DP World's Sokhna terminal in Egypt could emerge as key gateway

T E Raja Simhan
Recently in Ain Sokhna (Egypt)

With the Red Sea shipping situation showing signs of stabilisation, DP World's Sokhna terminal in Egypt could emerge as a key gateway for growing cargo traffic between India, Egypt and the Mediterranean, as geopolitical disruptions reshape shipping routes and push more cargo onto feeder services.

The strategic location of Sokhna, about 130 km from Cairo and at the southern entrance to the Suez Canal, gives it an advantage in handling cargo moving between India and Mediterranean markets, besides serving trade from China and other Asian markets, said Avnash Iyer, COO, Ports and Terminals, Sokhna, DP World.

The composition of traffic at Sokhna has changed sharply following the Red Sea crisis.

CRITICAL LINK

Before the crisis, around 80 per cent of the terminal's container traffic was handled by mainline vessels and 20 per cent were by feeders. The mix has now reversed, with feeders accounting for about 80 per cent and mainline vessels for 20 per cent, he said.

The terminal handles feeders ranging from 1,200 TEUs to 5,000 TEUs, while it can also accommodate mainline vessels of up to 18,000 TEUs. The shift was driven by geopolitical developments, with Chinese operators using the opportunity to establish new trade links, Iyer said.

“The India link is very critical because there is a significant cargo movement that



STRUCTURAL SHIFT. DP World's Sokhna terminal in Egypt handles feeders ranging from 1,200 TEUs to 5,000 TEUs

is happening between India and Egypt and India and the Mediterranean,” Iyer added.

The terminal played a significant role when vessels diverted cargo from Jeddah amid security threats in the Red Sea. Sokhna handled around 140,000 TEUs a month, with roughly 60 per cent comprising transshipment cargo.

Cargo flows are now recovering after a temporary

slowdown between April and June. Sokhna handled more than 80,000 TEUs of volume last month, while shipping-line confidence and cargo demand remain strong, Iyer said.

DP World is also expanding its logistics footprint beyond the terminal. Its bonded facility allows imported cargo to be moved out of the port while remaining under customs control until duties

are paid. Ashwani Sharma, President and CEO of Asepto, the aseptic liquid packaging business of the \$1.63-billion Noida-based UFlex Ltd, which has set up a plant at Sokhna, said, “Europe can be reached in around 10 days, depending on the destination, while GCC markets such as Saudi Arabia can be reached in two to 10 days. Shipping to markets such as Brazil and major US ports takes around 25-30 days, he said.”

CRUCIAL CHANGE

On Tuesday, global shipping majors Maersk and Hapag-Lloyd jointly announced a structural change to four of their services, which will now transit via the trans-Suez route instead of sailing around the Cape of Good Hope.

According to J Krishnan of

Natesa Iyer, a freight forwarder, while risks are always there in the Red Sea, the decision of shipping majors will be based on risk assessment. If the attacks return, they will stop and return to the Cape of Good Hope, he said.

ERNAKULAM REGIONAL CO-OPERATIVE MILK PRODUCERS' UNION LTD.
P.B. No. 2212, EDAPPALLY, KOCHI – 24

E-TENDER NOTICE
No. EU/PUR/38/VMP/2026-27 14.09.26
E-Tenders are invited for Supply of veterinary medicines for decentralized veterinary units under ERCMPU Ltd.
(Pre-Bid meeting: 18.09.26 4 PM)
E-tender id: 2026_KCMMF_869612_1
@http://elenders.kerala.gov.in
Bid submission end date 08.10.2026, 4 PM.
For More details: Tel: 0484 - 2541193.
Mail id: ercempupur@milma.com (Sd/- Managing Director)

COCHIN INTERNATIONAL AIRPORT LIMITED
CIAL/FS/AMC(FP)/2026-01 17.09.2026
ANNUAL MAINTENANCE CONTRACT FOR THE MAINTENANCE OF FIRE EXTINGUISHERS INSTALLED AT CIAL
Sealed tenders are invited from experienced agencies on behalf of Cochin International Airport Ltd. for the Annual maintenance contract for the maintenance of Fire extinguishers installed at CIAL.

Cost of tender document	EMD	Contract period
Rs.3,500/-	Rs.1,00,000/-	03 Years

Interested firms may submit their application on or before **07/10/2026**. For eligibility criteria and other details, visit website **www.cial.aero**.

Sd/-
MANAGING DIRECTOR

BEFORE THE NATIONAL COMPANY LAW TRIBUNAL, KOCHI BENCH AT KOCHI
IN THE MATTER OF THE COMPANIES ACT, 2013
IN THE MATTER OF KITEX CHILDRENSWEAR LIMITED AND KITEX GARMENTS LIMITED AND
AND
IN THE MATTER OF SCHEME OF ARRANGEMENT BETWEEN KITEX CHILDRENSWEAR LIMITED AND KITEX GARMENTS LIMITED AND THEIR RESPECTIVE SHAREHOLDERS AND CREDITORS
CP (CAA) NO.08/KOB/2026
C/W
CA (CAA)NO.01/KOB/2026

KITEX CHILDRENSWEAR LIMITED
Building No. 494, Kizhakkambalam, Vilangudi P.O., Aluva, Ernakulam, Kerala, India-683561

...PETITIONER COMPANY NO. 1 / DEMERGED COMPANY

KITEX GARMENTS LIMITED
Building No. VI/496, Kizhakkambalam, Vilangudi P.O., Aluva, Ernakulam, Kerala, India, 683561

...PETITIONER COMPANY NO. 2 / RESULTING COMPANY

NOTICE
A Petition under Sections 230 and 232 of the Companies Act, 2013 for sanctioning the Scheme of Arrangement between Kitex Childrenswear Limited and Kitex Garments Limited and their respective shareholders and creditors was filed by the Petitioners on 07.08.2026 and the said Petition came up for admission on 03.09.2026 and is fixed for hearing before the Hon'ble National Company Law Tribunal, Kochi Bench on 12.10.2026. Any person desirous of supporting or opposing the said Petition should send to the Petitioner's advocate at the address mentioned below, notice of such intention, in writing, signed by him/her or his/her advocate, with his/her full name and address, to reach the Petitioner's Advocate, not later than two (2) days before the date fixed for hearing of the Petition. Where he/she seeks to oppose the petition, the grounds of opposition or a copy of the affidavit, shall be furnished with such notice. A copy of the petition will be furnished by the undersigned to any person requiring the same, on payment of the prescribed charges for the same.

Sd/- J JOHN
SPJ Legal, Advocates
Unit No. 306, 3rd Floor, #30, Prestige Meridian II
MG Road, Bengaluru - 560 001
Email:saji@spjlegal.com

Kochi
September 17, 2026

QUICKLY.

Varshney re-appointed as SEBI WTM till 2029



Mumbai: The Appointments Committee of the Cabinet has approved the re-appointment of Kamlesh Chandra Varshney as Whole-time Member of the Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI) beyond September 19, 2026. Varshney will continue as SEBI WTM until he attains the age of 65 on August 4, 2029, or until further orders, whichever is earlier, according to an order issued by the Department of Personnel and Training dated September 15. *businessline* had reported earlier this month that Varshney was likely to get an extension, with government sources indicating that continuity was considered important as SEBI works through issues around the newly introduced closing auction session. **OUR BUREAU**

Manika IPO gets over 28x subscription on final day

New Delhi: The initial public offer (IPO) of Manika Plastech received 28.14 times subscription on the final day of bidding on Wednesday. The company's IPO received bids for 60,18,61,476 shares against 2,13,86,919 shares on offer, according to data available with the NSE. The portion for non-institutional investors was subscribed 63.09 times and the category for retail investors received 22.72 times subscription. The quota for Qualified Institutional Buyers (QIBs) was subscribed 10.94 times. The IPO has a price band of ₹40-43 per share and has a fresh issue aggregating up to ₹92.5 crore and an offer for sale of up to 76,74,418 shares. **PTI**

NSE raises ₹6,746 crore from anchor investors ahead of IPO

BETTING ON BOURSE. LIC gets biggest allocation at ₹450 cr; MFs account for nearly 37 per cent of anchor book

Akshata Gorde
Mumbai

The National Stock Exchange of India (NSE) has raised ₹6,746.18 crore from anchor investors ahead of its initial public offering, including the Life Insurance Corporation of India (LIC), Government Pension Fund Global, Monetary Authority of Singapore and several large domestic mutual funds. NSE allotted 3.78 crore shares to anchor investors at ₹1,785 per share, with LIC receiving the largest allocation at ₹450.30 crore, followed by Government Pension Fund Global at ₹249.99 crore and Monetary Authority of Singapore at ₹199.99 crore.

Among other large investors, SBI Life Insurance Company and HDFC Life Insurance Company received allocations of ₹149.99 crore each. Nippon India Large Cap Fund was allotted ₹139.99 crore, while Morgan Stanley Asia (Singapore) received ₹174.99 crore.

FOREIGN INVESTORS The anchor book also saw participation from several overseas institutional investors, including Abu Dhabi Investment Authority, Goldman Sachs, Fidelity Funds, Eastspring Investments India and Carmignac Portfolio. Abu Dhabi Investment Authority received an allocation of ₹199.99 crore, while Goldman Sachs Funds-Goldman Sachs India Equity

Major allottees		
Investors	No. of shares	Amount (₹ cr)
LIC	25,22,704	450.30
Govt Pension Fund	14,00,560	249.99
MA of Singapore	11,20,448	199.99
Abu Dhabi Inv	11,20,448	199.99
Fidelity Funds	9,98,520	178.23

Portfolio was allotted ₹84.80 crore. “Foreign institutional demand was very strong with investors spread across geographies US, Europe & Asia and categories participating with large numbers. This strong support will help boost the foreign investment inflow into the country,” the exchange said, adding that NSE is a proxy to the “India story”. More than 20 foreign long only funds are participating

in the book. FPIs are investing ₹2,883 crore or 43 per cent of the total anchor book. Domestic mutual funds accounted for a sizable part of the anchor book. Of the total anchor allocation, ₹2,494.99 crore, or 36.98 per cent, was allocated to 29 domestic mutual funds through 93 schemes. These included schemes of SBI Mutual Fund, ICICI Prudential Mutual Fund, HDFC Mutual Fund, Nippon India Mutual Fund, Kotak Mutual Fund, Axis

Mutual Fund, and Aditya Birla Sun Life Mutual Fund, among others. Among the larger mutual fund allocations, Nippon India Large Cap Fund received ₹139.99 crore, HDFC Flexi Cap Fund ₹129.99 crore, and SBI Banking & Financial Services Fund ₹99.99 crore. The anchor book also included several pension funds and insurance companies. The allocation comes ahead of NSE's IPO opening for subscription on Thursday and closing on next Monday. The public offer is entirely an offer for sale by existing shareholders comprising 12.64 crore shares, representing 5.11 per cent of the exchange's equity. The IPO which has been priced at ₹1,700-1,785 per share.

Nifty ekes out modest gains after brutal sell-off

Anupama Ghosh
Mumbai

The markets clawed back some ground on Wednesday after the previous session's sharp sell-off, but gains remained tentative as investors held back ahead of the US Federal Reserve's policy decision. Elevated crude oil prices, a weakening rupee and persistent selling in technology stocks kept sentiment fragile even as banking, FMCG and realty counters offered support. The Nifty 50 settled at 23,217.60, up 99 points, while the BSE Sensex closed at 74,336.45, gaining 332.63 points. The recovery, however, lacked conviction, as the Nifty Midcap 100 ended nearly flat, and the Nifty Smallcap 100 fell 0.18 per cent, marking its fifth consecutive session of losses. Market breadth remained weak. “Markets are likely to re-

act to the outcome of the US Fed meeting and its commentary in early trade on Thursday,” said Ajit Mishra of Religare Broking, adding that the broader structure “remains weak” despite the day's recovery. Sectoral action was uneven. FMCG, PSU Banks, Realty and Financial Services were among the gainers, while IT, Pharma and Healthcare ended in the red following recent outperformance. SBI Life, HDFC Life and ITC led gains among Nifty 50 stocks, while TCS, Wipro, Infosys and Tech Mahindra bore the brunt of profit-taking. On the economic front, HDFC Securities' August Bharat Barometer painted a mixed picture. While the external sector and banking system showed strength, with robust export growth, strong bank credit and deposit expansion, and positive FII inflows, domestic demand signals were softer.

Mirae Asset AIF settles SEBI case for ₹12.75 lakh

Our Bureau
Mumbai

Capital market regulator SEBI has settled enforcement proceedings against Mirae Asset Venture Opportunity Trust AIF, its manager and six key managerial personnel after the fund exceeded the regulatory limit on investments in a single company. The case relates to the Mirae Asset Late Stage Opportunities Fund, a scheme of the Category II Alternative Investment Fund (AIF), which invested ₹128 crore in Supermarket Grocery Supplies. As of June 30, 2023, the in-

vestment accounted for 38 per cent of the scheme's investable funds of ₹334 crore, exceeding the 25 per cent limit prescribed for investments in a single investee company. SEBI's examination of the fund's Private Placement Memorandum Audit Report for 2023-24, along with the AIF's subsequent replies, found that the concentration exceeded the prescribed threshold during part of the review period. The investment represented 25.11 per cent of the scheme's investable funds in March 2023 before rising to 38 per cent in June 2023. It later fell to 24.44 per cent by September 30, 2023.

SIP returns in last three years remain lacklustre

Suresh P Iyengar
Mumbai

Notwithstanding the highest-ever inflow of ₹32,297 crore through SIP in August, most of the equity funds have delivered single-digit returns in the last three years. The overall inflows through SIP at ₹1.58 lakh crore in the last 5 months have touched 45 per cent of the last fiscal inflow of ₹3.5 lakh crore. In fact, except for the average SIP return of 13 per cent each from small and mid-cap funds, all the schemes have delivered a single-digit return on the back of healthy investor interest, according

to the data sourced from Geojit Research.

STRONG INFLOWS However, over past year, small and mid-cap funds have delivered a return of 28 per cent and 18 per cent, largely on the back of strong inflows in these schemes. Aditya Agarwal, CFA, Chief Investment Officer at Avisia Wealth Creators, said SIP growth remains steady despite modest 1-3 year returns because investors increasingly view SIPs as a disciplined, long-term wealth-creation tool rather than a short-term return strategy. Volatility does not automatically increase risk; regular investing enables rupee-

Average SIP CAGR - as of Aug'26			
MF category	1 year	3 year	5 year
Contra	4.51	6.70	12.84
Div Yield	5.16	6.33	12.04
ELSS	6.20	6.15	10.83
Flexicap	10.54	7.88	11.63
Focused	11.38	8.35	11.48
Large & Midcap	11.09	9.45	13.33
Largcap	2.56	5.04	9.00
Midcap	18.49	12.81	16.60
Multicap	14.52	9.71	13.37
Smallcap	27.68	13.03	16.70
Value	6.48	6.72	12.12

Source: Geojit Research

cost averaging, though excessive exposure to mid- and small-cap funds should be avoided, he said. Yudhajit Baul, Founder, Yudhajit Financial Services, said despite

the headwinds of geopolitics, sub-par monsoon and high crude oil prices, earnings growth are expected to be strong in September quarter. The increase in SIP flows

amid volatile markets talks volumes about the growing maturity of the retail investors, he said.

SYSTEMATIC APPROACH Sriram BKR, Senior Investment Strategist, Geojit Financial Services, said the systematic approach of investing in volatile asset like equities and taking smaller steps for long-term goals have gone a long way in shaping the investors behaviour in the recent volatile and low-return environment. However, he added equity is a high risk asset leading to extended periods of draw-downs and it is very important to continue with SIP through the low return periods.

Kanohar Electricals ends Day 1 with 19% gains



MODEST DEBUT. Krishnan Iyer, Senior VP, NSE (centre right), with Kanohar Electricals officials and family members at the listing ceremony of company shares on Wednesday

Our Bureau
Bengaluru

Kanohar Electricals shares made a positive debut on Wednesday, listing at an 8.4 per cent premium at ₹685.50 on the NSE compared with the IPO price of ₹632. On the BSE, Kanohar Electricals shares listed at ₹672.05 and later zoomed to ₹783.95. It ended at ₹751.5 on the NSE and at ₹751.3 on the BSE, representing a gain 19 per cent over IPO price. Shivani Nyati, Head of Wealth at Swastika Investment, said the company's fundamentals, including 42

per cent ROE, 70 per cent ROCE, 0.10x debt-to-equity and a ₹1,818-crore order book, support the brokerage's original subscribe view. The ₹1,056-crore IPO was subscribed 90.59 times, led by QIBs (215.37 times), NIIIs (87.74 times) and retail investors (20.51 times). The IPO comprised a fresh issue of ₹300 crore and an OFS of ₹756 crore and ahead of IPO it raised ₹317 crore from anchor investors. The company plans to use ₹64.1 crore towards capex, ₹155 crore to fund incremental working capital needs and for general corporate purposes.

Prasol Chem makes dull listing, stock ends below IPO price

Our Bureau
Bengaluru

Prasol Chemicals made a weak debut on the stock market on Wednesday, but managed to close near the offer price of ₹676. The stock began trading at a 9.7 per cent discount on the NSE at ₹610 before ending at the 10% upper price band of ₹671, above the listing price. On the BSE, it debuted at a 9.6 per cent discount at ₹611 and subsequently closed at ₹672.05, the upper circuit. The company's ₹500-crore IPO was subscribed 3.30 times. The QIB portion was subscribed 7.22 times, while the NII and retail portions were booked 1.80 times and 1.70 times, respectively. Proceeds from the fresh issue will be used for repayment of debt, meeting working capital requirements and general corporate purposes.

SEBI freezes ₹28 crore, bars broker from derivatives trading over price rigging

Our Bureau
Mumbai

The Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI), has ordered freezing of bank accounts of Mumbai-based stock broker Prrsaar Sampada and Chaubara Eats holding nearly ₹28.12 crore, accusing them of manipulating prices in stock futures and options through a co-ordinated trading scheme. The companies allegedly booked large profits in stock options while taking matching losses in stock futures on the same shares, artificially moving prices in the process. The regulator examined 23 scrip-days in detail for both parties involved, covering stocks such as KFin Technologies, Swiggy, Prestige Estates, Bharat Dynamics, Godrej Properties, Waaree Energies, Jio Financial Services and Hindustan Zinc, among others. The trades



took place between December 2025 and June 2026. “The cross-segment price manipulation using stock options and stock futures, while also engaging in possible deceptive orders and coordinated/synchronised trading, is a novel manipulative, fraudulent and unfair trade practice employed by the suspects to deceive other market participants and profit from price fluctuation artificially induced by them in the market,” whole-time member Kamlesh Varshney said in an ex-parte interim order on Wednesday. The regulator said Prrsaar

stopped the activity in its own account after the National Stock Exchange first raised concerns, but the same pattern continued through Chaubara, as recently as August 2026. Four individuals linked to the companies were Ved Prakash Gupta and Priti Gupta from Prrsaar, and Saroj Gupta and Gaurav Tomar from Chaubara. **ILLEGAL GAINS** SEBI has ordered an impounding of ₹22.06 crore linked to Prrsaar and ₹6.05 crore linked to Chaubara as illegal gains. All six parties are barred from trading in derivatives until that money is deposited in a fixed deposit account. They can still trade in regular stocks. Their demat accounts are frozen, and they must list all their assets within 15 days. The six parties have 21 days to respond to SEBI or request a hearing.

BROKER'S CALL.

Emkay Global

AVENUE SUPERMARTS (SELL) Target: ₹3,700 CMP: ₹3,711.95 Our monthly basket tracker for Avenue Supermarts (DMart) has seen a 6-7 per cent inflation in its bill size, led by a broad-based increase of 8-14 per cent across categories, barring personal care, which is down around 3 per cent (vs last year). In addition, we believe the increase in net bill value for retailers like DMart should see an additional 2-3 per cent benefit, due to GST reduction in Sep-25. Ceteris paribus, an inflationary period is beneficial for retailers in the short term, from a bill size perspective. However, we will be closely monitoring its impact on bill cuts and a possible cut in discretionary consumption. With respect to competitive intensity from q-comm players, we are noticing some reduction in discounting at Zepto, though Amazon Now remains aggressive in terms of cashback offers and Flipkart Minutes is seeing growing traction in tier-2+ towns, as per media reports. Blinkit continues to lead with focused initiatives around experience, assortment, and accessibility. In our view, DMart has a strong brand recall but has been slow on TAM expansion in terms of categories (50 per cent of India retail TAM), consumer cohorts (low/mid income), and sales channels (largely via physical stores). The stock has been an underperformer and down about 20 per cent over the last 12 months. The re-rating requires more sustainable SSG drivers, rather than short-term inflation triggers, in our view. We maintain Sell with an unchanged TP of ₹3,700 (55x Sep-28E EPS).

Motilal Oswal Financial

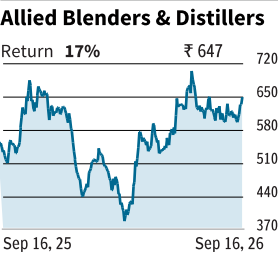
HAPPY FORGINGS (BUY) Target: ₹2,438 CMP: ₹2,157 We met with Happy Forgings' (HFL) management, with discussions centered around incremental growth avenues, capacity ramp-up across forgings and machining to cater to the order book, and the steady outlook for the core CV and tractor segments. The ₹950 crore order book is expected to drive majority of topline growth over FY27-29, with PVs and industrials accounting for about 70 per cent of the order book. While PVs and Industrials combined currently contribute 24 per cent to revenue, management expects their contribution to rise to 45-50 per cent over the medium term. These orders are secured at higher realisations and better margins, which, combined with the captive solar project, is expected to drive structural margin expansion over FY26-29. We expect margins to expand to 33 per cent by FY29 from 31 per cent currently. Driven by new order wins, higher realisations, an improving mix, operating leverage and benefits of the captive solar plant that will come on stream in FY28, we expect HFL to record revenue/EBITDA/PAT CAGR of 25/28/30 per cent over FY26-29. We reiterate our Buy rating on the stock with a TP of ₹2,438 (based on 38x Sep'28E EPS).

businessline is not responsible for the recommendations sourced from third party brokerages. Reports may be sent to: blmarketwatch@gmail.com

TODAY'S PICK.

Allied Blenders and Distillers (₹647.60): BUY

Gurumurthy K
bl. research bureau



The short-term outlook for Allied Blenders and Distillers is bullish. The stock is moving up after forming a strong base around ₹580 over the last two months. Immediate support is in the ₹625-₹630 region. Below that, the ₹610-₹600 region is the next strong support and can limit the downside if the price falls below ₹625. We expect the stock to hold above the ₹630-₹625 support zone. Allied Blenders and Distillers share price can rise to ₹715 in the coming weeks. Traders can buy Allied Blenders and Distillers shares now at ₹648. Accumulate on dips at

₹634. Keep the stop-loss at ₹605 initially. Trail the stop-loss to ₹655 as soon as the stock rises to ₹665. Revise the stop-loss higher to ₹670 and ₹690 when the price touches ₹685 and ₹705, respectively. Exit the long positions at ₹710. Note: The recommendations are based on technical analysis. There is a risk of loss in trading

Day trading guide

23276 » Nifty 50 Futures

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
23180	23000	23340	23410	Wait for a rise. Go short 23320 with a stop-loss at 23370

₹721 » HDFC Bank

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
713	708	730	740	Go long on dips at 718 and 715 with a stop-loss at 711

₹1058 » Infosys

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
1045	1025	1070	1080	Take fresh shorts below 1045. Keep the stop-loss at 1050

₹265 » ITC

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
263	261	266	270	Go long only above 266. Stop-loss can be kept at 265

₹235 » ONGC

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
233	231	237	240	Can go either way from here. Stay out of this stock for now

₹1247 » Reliance Ind.

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
1230	1205	1255	1275	Go short now and at 1253. Stop-loss can be kept at 1260

₹988 » SBI

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
977	967	990	997	Go short with a stop-loss at 992 if SBI fails to breach 990

₹2183 » TCS

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
2170	2120	2205	2235	Go short on a break below 2170. Keep the stop-loss at 2180

S1, S2: Support 1 & 2; R1, R2: Resistance 1 & 2.

S1, S2: Support 1 & 2; R1, R2: Resistance 1 & 2.

Nifty 50 Movers					
	Close(%)	Pts	PE	WN(%)	
State Bank	991.40	21.14	10.21	3.86	
HDFC Bank	721.50	16.56	13.47	10.40	
ICICI Bank	1358.80	13.15	16.31	9.16	
ITC	264.15	12.95	16.40	2.40	
Axis Bank	1241.00	11.36	13.82	3.35	
Kotak Bank	415.00	8.37	20.34	2.88	
M&M	3070.00	7.90	18.86	2.58	
Reliance Ind.	1240.00	6.94	19.03	7.88	
Titan	4908.50	4.74	75.65	1.91	
Wind Unilever	1962.00	4.63	43.93	1.40	
Hindalco	972.70	4.43	13.33	1.33	
SBI Life	1697.90	4.30	65.49	0.72	
Sun Pharma	1853.50	4.28	36.70	1.85	
Bajaj Auto	11593.00	4.09	28.05	1.21	
JSW Steel	1248.90	4.04	10.91	1.10	
NestleIndia	1384.50	3.53	70.05	0.93	
HDFC Life	1530.20	3.31	57.93	0.54	
Bharti Airtel	1835.00	3.06	30.71	5.25	
Trent Ltd.	2769.70	2.89	81.39	0.87	
Eternal Ltd.	317.00	2.76	706.50	2.16	
Bharat Elec	385.75	2.23	45.87	1.30	
TataConsumerProduct	1000.10	1.99	60.27	0.61	
Adani Ports	1723.50	1.62	30.37	1.22	
Coal India	422.25	1.57	8.34	0.95	
Eicher Motors	7500.00	1.43	35.66	0.97	
Asian Paints	2416.60	1.36	47.92	1.03	
Grasim Ind	3187.00	1.32	19.06	1.13	
Cipla	1358.00	0.86	32.69	0.72	
ONGC	1268.80	0.72	6.65	0.87	
UltraTech Cement	10700.00	0.68	36.79	1.19	
PowerGrid Corp	262.80	0.00	15.38	1.12	
HCL Tech	1253.00	-0.16	19.50	1.24	
Shriram Finance Ltd.	979.00	-0.24	20.35	1.29	
Apollo Hosp	8696.50	-0.39	57.17	0.84	
Adani Enter	2920.00	-0.54	50.56	0.79	
Jio Financial Services Ltd.	224.00	-0.87	71.84	0.69	
Dr Reddys Lab	114.00	-0.67	29.89	0.65	
Max Healthcare	1025.00	-0.81	68.45	0.72	
Tata Steel	183.00	-1.17	20.28	1.42	
Tata Motors PV	301.00	-1.19	0.00	0.59	
Bajaj Finance	1006.20	-1.76	30.34	2.54	
Wipro	1389.50	-1.84	12.44	1.43	
Maruti Suzuki	12166.00	-1.85	26.68	1.49	
Int'lGlobeWri	4733.50	-2.10	0.00	1.01	
Bajaj Finserv	1837.00	-2.34	14.25	1.00	
Tech Mahindra	1558.00	-2.48	29.57	0.93	
NTPC	327.00	-2.59	11.19	1.46	
L&T	380.70	-11.00	26.69	4.19	
Infosys	1060.00	-13.03	14.15	3.50	
TCS	2188.80	-13.88	15.82	2.10	

Pts: Impact on index movement

Nifty Next 50 Movers					
	Close(%)	Pts	PE	WN(%)	
Indian Oilcorp	134.75	29.53	5.33	2.08	
Bpcl	303.35	27.68	7.68	2.54	
Cummins India	4940.00	25.91	57.85	2.76	
Punjab Natl Bank	116.80	23.02	6.06	1.66	
PidlitInd	1543.80	20.44	58.71	1.98	
Venusuper	3720.00	17.83	79.36	2.48	
Macrotech Developers	1087.40	18.22	26.31	1.25	
Union Bank	178.20	17.97	6.59	1.42	
Britannia Ind	4999.50	17.80	46.13	2.43	
United Spirits	1389.50	16.22	59.91	1.70	
Muthofin	2771.40	15.50	9.71	1.23	
Radico	312.65	15.06	6.13	1.61	
Greenenergy	1220.20	14.81	97.50	1.76	
Bank of Baroda	234.98	12.61	6.61	1.80	
Bosch	4755.50	12.23	59.35	1.70	
Hindus Zinc	567.50	9.22	14.05	1.13	
Indial Steel	1103.30	8.61	41.54	1.69	
Power Finance	36.04	8.46	3.39	1.07	
Canara Bank	123.20	8.11	5.64	2.78	
Godrej Consumer	863.00	7.01	46.15	1.43	
Hyundai Motor India	2155.00	6.22	35.37	1.27	
Gydsolidfences	1107.50	6.18	24.26	1.14	
Adani Power	202.34	4.10	26.85	3.47	
Oil	622.80	3.64	34.68	1.65	
Varun Beverages	4140.20	3.18	40.72	2.32	
Energy Solutions	119.20	1.62	52.45	1.83	
Samaradmothersoierintemall	158.27	1.51	36.67	2.89	
Industaradmothersoierintemall	469.60	1.31	31.55	2.77	
Mazagon Dock	2231.90	-0.91	31.55	0.70	
Indian Railway Finance Corp	78.95	-1.17	14.35	0.66	
Ammbuja Cements	381.05	-1.27	18.26	0.98	
Gail (India)	170.65	-1.80	11.37	1.90	
Abb India	6980.00	-3.81	95.11	1.51	
Siemens Energy / India	3013.40	-3.93	72.12	1.10	
Greens Hotels Co.	48.40	-4.08	43.80	2.59	
Greens Cement	21795.00	-4.28	48.06	1.20	
Vedanta	256.00	-4.93	6.00	1.79	
Adani Ports	3742.00	-7.19	91.73	1.37	
Vysy Mtrp Corp.	4033.00	-11.61	53.21	3.91	
Tata Power	36.40	-12.60	21.91	2.48	
Power & Ind Sol	345.51	-12.85	108.62	2.41	
Tata Capital	382.50	-14.41	26.82	2.71	
Divis Lab	9158.00	-14.77	73.32	1.81	
Torrent Pharma	4812.50	-15.99	84.90	2.92	
Tata Motors Cv	424.25	-17.60	37.31	3.66	
Hdfc AMC	2373.10	-21.27	34.41	2.00	
Ajaj Holdings	10930.00	-21.39	13.53	1.95	
Solar Industries	18900.00	-24.78	83.41	1.90	
timindiree	4233.00	-30.66	24.16	1.62	
Cholansandamfin	1765.60	-32.69	26.17	3.15	
Pts: Impact on index movement					

QUICKLY.

Gold gains as yields slip ahead of Fed rate decision



Gold rose over one per cent as crude oil prices and US Treasury yields declined, while investors awaited the US Federal Reserve's interest rate decision. Spot gold was up 1.4 per cent at \$4,353.82 per ounce as of 1325 GMT. US gold futures for December delivery rose 1.4 per cent to \$4,395.10. **REUTERS**

Arabica coffee hits fresh 10-week low

London: Arabica coffee futures on the ICE exchange hit a fresh 10-week low, given benign weather in Brazil and surging exports, while raw sugar hit a two-week trough. Arabica coffee fell 0.7 per cent to \$2.8170 per lb at 1147GMT. Robusta coffee fell 1.8 per cent to \$3,418 a tonne. Raw sugar slipped 0.3 per cent to 17.88 cents/lb. October white sugar fell 0.4 per cent to \$524.20/tonne. **REUTERS**

Copper rises with signs of active demand from China



London: Copper prices rose supported by signs of active demand in top consumer China, though traders were wary of potential volatility ahead of the US Fed's interest rate decision. Three-month copper on the LME gained 1.1 per cent to \$14,231 a tonne. Nickel gained 1.7 per cent to \$16,240. **REUTERS**

China bans 3 more Indian rice exporters over GMOs

ERECTING NON-TARIFF BARRIERS? Indian shippers say rejected consignments did not show genetic material when re-exported to other nations

Subramani Ra Mancombu
Chennai

China has revoked the registrations of 3 more Indian rice exporters on the alleged presence of genetically modified organisms. But Indian exporters say Beijing is indulging in a trade war, erecting non-tariff barriers. Trade sources said Kakinada-based Sarala Foods and Pattabhi Agro Foods in Andhra Pradesh and New Delhi-based Om India Trading Ltd are the affected exporters. This takes the total number of exporters whose licenses have been revoked to 10. However, Mukesh Jain, President of the Rice Exporters Association, Chhattis-

garh, told *businessline* that China's rejection of Indian rice shipments was suspicious, raising concerns that Beijing was erecting a non-tariff barrier. **‘DIDN'T CONFORM TO SPECIFICATIONS’** “The rejected consignments were brought back to India and tested by the Food Safety and Standards Authority of India (FSSAI). No presence of GMO was found in the consignments. We re-exported the rice to other countries, where too quality inspections did not find anything wrong,” he said. BV Krishna Rao, President of The Rice Exporters Federation and Managing Director of Pattabhi Agro Foods, said the General Administrations



EXPORT HURDLES. Chinese authorities rejected 146 shipments for containing GM material in the first half of 2026

of Customs of the People's Republic of China (GACC) informed that the rice shipments sent to Beijing “did not conform to specifications”. “Our Chinese buyer said his authorities found the

presence of GMOs and only on landing did the Chinese authorities report the presence of GMOs. According to former US Department of Agriculture (USDA) official Fred Gales, China is causing “consternation and puzzlement” by detecting and rejecting genetically modified material in food shipments from trading partners who claim that they don't grow GM crops. He said Chinese authorities rejected 146 shipments for containing GM material in the first half of 2026. “More interesting is that Chinese inspectors have found GMOs in shipments of rapeseed oil, rice, flour and soybean foods,” he said, adding that these include Russia, Belarus, Kazakhstan

and Japan, which do not grow GM crops. “We don't find any point in exporting to China. Trade has come to a total halt. While it costs \$250 to ship a rice container, to get back the rejected shipment, we have to pay \$2,500,” said Rao. Jain said the cost to get back the rejected consignment is as high as \$4,000-4,500. “It looks like China is trying to help Pakistan gain because our volumes have increased. Now, exporters from Islamabad gain in volume and price too,” he said. **QUESTIONABLE MOVES** Chinese now pay a higher price for rice from other destinations, particularly Pakistan. Jain said various

rice associations raised the issue with Commerce Secretary Rajesh Agrawal, who assured to discuss this with foreign trade ministers at last week's BRICS meet. Queries sent to officials were unanswered until this report was published. Gales said China's rejection of rice from India coincides with its attempt to sell off old rice from its reserves (which began in March). All but one of the Indian shipments rejected were broken rice, a cheap product that directly competes with ageing rice from China's reserves. China has not rejected rice from other suppliers of broken rice such as Vietnam, Myanmar and Pakistan, though.

Soybean imports may touch record high of 1 million tonnes

Vishwanath Kulkarni
Bengaluru

Soybean imports for the oil year 2025-26 ending September are likely to be at an all-time high, touching about a million tonnes, driven by a shortfall in domestic supplies. In the previous year, soybean imports stood at a mere 0.02 lakh tonnes (lt). With rain playing truant and weak monsoon seen impacting the current kharif 2026 crop amidst a dip in planted area, the imports are likely to be sustained in the new oil year. As per the latest demand supply estimates by the trade body Soybean Processors Association of India (SOPA), soybean imports stood at 9.34 lt during October-August period of oil year 2025-

26. Including the purchases for September, the total imports are likely to top 9.5 lt. The previous high in soybean imports were about 7 lt during 2022-23. **NON-GMO IMPORTS** India, an exporter of soybean till 2017-18, turned a net importer during 2018-19 and since then the import volumes were on the rise till 2022-23. Imports came down during 2023-24 and 2024-25, before rebounding to an all time high in the current year. India imports mainly the non-genetically modified soybean from the least developed countries (LDCs) in sub-Saharan Africa such as Niger, Togo and Nigeria, where the non-GM varieties are largely grown. SOPA had estimated soybean production of 110.26 lt

for 2025-26, about 14 per cent lower than 128.82 lt a year ago, due to a decline in area and the output being impacted by weather vagaries. Total crushing for the oil year 2025-26 are estimated lower at 104.50 lt (113.50 lt). **LOWER CRUSHING** As a result of lower crushing, the production of soybean meal is expected to be lower at 82.46 lt (89.56 lt). Consumption by the feed sector is projected marginally higher at 63 lt (62 lt), while the offtake from the food sector is estimated higher at 9 lt (8 lt). Exports of soymeal have halved to 10 lt on lack of price parity. Per the Agriculture Ministry, soybean has been planted on about 122.08 lakh hectares this kharif, a tad lower than last year 123 lh.

Top 11 districts in Uttar Pradesh report drop in cane area, sugar output may be hit

Prabhudatta Mishra
New Delhi

The 11 major sugar producing districts in Uttar Pradesh, where the top 20 mills are located and which have a combined share of 68 per cent in the State's production of 89.52 lakh tonnes (lt) of the commodity in the current season, may have to face problems. This is because the acreage has slipped 1.6 per cent amid factories preparing to start crushing early. Besides, a likely early start of factories with lower recovery and the demand from local gur manufacturers (kolhus) may also limit cane supply, potentially affecting overall sugar production in the State. Latest data show that 32.11 lt of sugar was produced only by 20 sugar



SUPPLY CRUNCH. An early start to factory operations, lower recovery and demand from local gur manufacturers may also constrain cane supplies

mills, including the top three by Triveni Engineering and DCM Shriram at their Khatauli, Ajhapur and Daurala mills. On the other hand, based on the locations of these 20 mills, there are 11 districts which are crucial for sugar production in the State in the upcoming season. **GUR THREAT** Sugar production in the current season, which will end

on September 30, in these 11 districts — Amroha, Bijnor, Bulandshahr, Hardoi, Lakhimpur Kheri, Meerut, Muzaffarnagar, Pilibhit, Saharanpur, Shahjahanpur and Sitapur — was 60.96 lt. However, the acreage of sugarcane, which will be available for crushing in the 2026-27 season starting October 1, in these districts has slipped to 17.14 lakh hectares.

“The government has been insisting on early crushing, and if that happens it will result in lower production since recovery will drop. Now that both ex-mill and retail prices have declined, the prices may not surge and there may be a marginal drop from the current level,” said sugarcane expert DK Tyagi. Industry experts said as there is a demand for *gur* (jaggery) amid its retail price crossing ₹100/kg this year and now selling at about ₹90 in Uttar Pradesh, sugar mills will face competition from these units in October as local *kolhus* are likely to pay more than the government-set rate for sugarcane. Farmer leader VM Singh said sugar mills should not ask for incentives as the *gur* units paid higher than SAP this season without any government support.

Rain ahead in South Peninsula as Bay braces for stormy weather

Vinson Kurian
Thiruvananthapuram

The India Meteorological Department (IMD) confirmed on Wednesday that a fresh low-pressure area may form over the north Andaman Sea in the larger Bay of Bengal basin on Saturday, coinciding with the expected start of the South-West monsoon's withdrawal from parts of West Rajasthan. The ‘low’ may intensify and move towards the south Odisha-north Andhra Pradesh coast over the first 3-4 days of next week. Initial indications suggest that it may not intensify into a tropical cyclone. However, the timing is meteorologically significant. As the monsoon begins to withdraw, the atmosphere over the Bay starts preparing for the North-East Monsoon, or the ‘reverse monsoon’, over the South Peninsula.

Isolated heavy rain is forecast for Tamil Nadu, Puducherry, Karaikal, Kerala and Mahe for four days from Thursday

The transition usually opens the door for vigorous weather systems over the Bay, bringing rain, thunderstorms and gusty winds to parts of the South Peninsula, which witnessed a significant rain deficit this season. *businessline* had flagged this possibility on Wednesday, pointing to a storm ‘pulse’ travelling in from the South China Sea. The IMD has now provided the synoptic sequence: Acyclonic circulation over north Thailand is expected to emerge over the north Andaman Sea on Friday, a day ahead of the projected low pressure area.

FRESH ‘LOW’ TO FORM The system could later intensify into the latest, and possibly the last, significant weather system of the South-West monsoon season. The IMD has forecast isolated heavy rain over Tamil Nadu, Puducherry, Karaikal, Kerala and Mahe for four days from Thursday. South interior Karnataka could receive isolated heavy rain for four days from Saturday, while coastal Andhra Pradesh, Yanam and Rayalaseema are expected to see rain for three days from Saturday. Telangana could also receive isolated heavy rain for four days from Saturday. Strong surface winds are expected over coastal Andhra Pradesh, Yanam, north interior Karnataka, Rayalaseema and south interior Karnataka for four days.

Copper: Wait and watch as outlook is unclear

Gurumurthy K
bl. research bureau

Copper prices have come down in the past week. The copper futures contract traded on the MCX touched a high of ₹1,431 per kg on Thursday last week and has declined from there. The contract touched a low of ₹1,350 on Tuesday and is attempting to bounce back from there. It is currently trading at ₹1,372. **COMMODITY CALL.** The near-term outlook is slightly mixed. Support is in the ₹1,350-₹1,340 region and resistance is around ₹1,390. So, for now, we can look at a range of ₹1,340-₹1,390 for some time. A breakout on either side of ₹1,340 or ₹1,390 will then determine the next direction of move. A break above ₹1,390 can



ease the downside pressure. That, in turn, can take the contract higher to ₹1,435. Eventually, the contract has to surpass ₹1,435 to gather momentum. Only, then will the upside open up to see ₹1,500 levels. On the other hand, if the contract breaks below ₹1,340, it could come under more pressure. Such a break could drag it down to ₹1,280. We will have to wait and watch what happens. **TRADE STRATEGY** Since the immediate outlook is unclear, we suggest that traders stay out of the market.

Crude oil slips as Saudi offers more crude via Oman

Reuters

Crude oil prices fell on Wednesday as reports that Saudi Arabia was offering additional crude cargoes via Oman eased concerns about the scale of West Asian supply disruptions. Brent crude futures were down 59 cents to \$108.16 a barrel at 0926 GMT. US West Texas Intermediate futures were down \$1.20 at \$104.63. Separately, US crude oil, gasoline and distillate inventories all rose last week, market sources said on Tuesday, citing data from the American Petroleum Institute. Crude inventories rose by 7.1 million barrels in the week ended September 11, the sources said, citing API data. That compared with analysts' expectations for a draw of about 1.6 million barrels, according to a *Reuters* poll.

CIFT gets patent for antimicrobial booster technology

Our Bureau
Kochi

The ICAR-Central Institute of Fisheries Technology (ICAR-CIFT), Kochi, has got an Indian patent for an antimicrobial booster technology. The invention, titled ‘A process for preparation of pigment-doped zinc oxide particles’, provides a method to coat zinc oxide nanoparticles with the naturally occurring microbial pigment violacein. Bacterial pigments are naturally occurring coloured substances produced by certain bacteria. Violacein, a violet pigment produced particularly by *Chromobacterium violaceum*, is known for its antimicrobial properties. Zinc oxide nano-

particles (ZnO-NPs) also possess antimicrobial properties. The patented process combines violacein with ZnO nanoparticles through a coating process. Under tested conditions, the violacein-coated ZnO nanoparticles showed enhanced antimicrobial activity and lower toxicity than uncoated ZnO nanoparticles. The material demonstrated about three to four times higher antimicrobial activity than the earlier material under the tested conditions. The technology has potential applications in antimicrobial medical, biomedical and pharmaceutical formulations, as well as in food preservation. The patented process offers a novel approach to enhance the functional properties of zinc oxide nanoparticles using a natural microbial pigment.

Livestock product exports up 44% in April-August

Vishwanath Kulkarni
Bengaluru

Exports of livestock products registered a 44 per cent growth to over \$3.132 billion during April-August of the current financial year, driven by strong demand for buffalo meat and other products. In the same period last year, the exports were \$2.177 billion. As per the Commerce Ministry's quick estimates, export of meat, dairy and poultry products in August 2026 touched \$694 million, up 37.1 per cent from \$506 million in the same month last year. A category-wise break-up of the latest export figures for buffalo meat, dairy and poultry products was not available.



BUFFALO MEAT Stakeholders said much of the growth in livestock product exports was driven by a strong demand for buffalo meat from Vietnam, Malaysia and other markets. “The 44 per cent rise in India's animal product exports to \$3.1 billion during April-August is a clear indication that global demand for Indian livestock products is strengthening. Buffalo meat

continues to be a key driver of this trade, while poultry, dairy, eggs and other animal-origin products are also contributing to the growth,” said Divya Kumar Gulati, Chairman, CLFMA of India, the apex trade body of livestock feed makers. “India has built a strong presence across markets such as Vietnam, Egypt, the UAE, Malaysia and Saudi Arabia, which together reflect the growing acceptance of animal products across Southeast Asia, West Asia and Africa,” he said. “The current growth is being supported by competitive pricing, consistent demand from overseas markets and improving export infrastructure and quality compliance. The opportunity now is to take this momentum beyond a few major products and markets by ex-

panding the export basket, strengthening traceability and meeting the evolving quality requirements of global buyers. This can create a larger and more stable export opportunity for the entire livestock value chain, including farmers,” Gulati said. During 2025-26, livestock product exports registered a 22 per cent growth to \$6.215 billion from \$5.096 billion in the previous year. **DAIRY, POULTRY** Sources in the dairy sector said that shipments of ghee and, to some extent, skimmed milk powder contributed to the growth. As far as poultry exports are concerned, India mainly exports eggs and egg powder. Poultry meat exports are not viable as the domestic cost of production is high.

‘Sulphur is emerging as a key crop nutrient’

Subramani Ra Mancombu
Chennai

Sulphur has emerged as an important crop nutrient over the past 2-3 years, and its usage has begun to increase in India, according to Bimal Shah, Managing Director of SML (formerly Sulphur Mills Ltd). “Recently, sulphur demand has suddenly started spiking. Otherwise, it was just a raw material or a by-product of oil refineries. It is seen as a crop nutrient as well as a crop production product,” he told *businessline* in an online interaction. The use of sulphur in India is not at the level of nitrogen (N), phosphorus (P) and potassium (K). This is because the government offers subsidy for NPK fertilizers. “Tapping the potential of

sulphur in all the crop inputs is far off. So, there's a lot of potential to rise from where we are right now. Sulphur is not only key for the soil, but also helps in the uptake of other nutrients,” said Shah. **MAJOR CHALLENGES** However, there are challenges in reaching sulphur to farmers, as it does not yet qualify as a fourth major nutrient. But sulphur-based mixtures could help reduce the use of other generic fertilizers that cause environmental problems. However, the chemical is facing problems currently, as the Iran war has affected its availability and led to a spike in prices. But speciality nutrient-based and speciality fertilizer-based sulphur products should move more as it is being used less, he said.



Bimal Shah, MD, SML

The spike in sulphur prices could make people understand its importance. SML has launched new formulations with sulphur. “We discovered a technology where, due to particle size reduction and other technologies, we were able to value-add normal sulphur to other formulations,” said Shah, adding that SML is expanding its product development. The company's technology helps in using sulphur

with other nutrients in a balanced way that “farmers have the right solution at the right time without incurring additional costs”, he said. SML is now trying sustainable and environmentally friendly solutions, providing balanced nutrition to the crop. The company is selling its products to over 80 countries, including Brazil and Turkey. Stating that the use of sulphur for crop protection is not high compared with other countries, Shah said what people have to remember is that sulphur is organic and can provide a natural solution. The country's sulphur requirement runs into millions of tonnes, he said, adding that India could source sulphur at competitive prices as most refineries producing it as a byproduct are located in West Asia.

QUICKLY.

Chennai port sets record in pig iron export handling

Chennai: The Chennai port has achieved an all-time record in the export of pig iron by handling 14,778 tonnes on a single day on Monday. The record shipment to Türkiye was executed through Supra Monarch at Jawahar Dock – VI, surpassing the previous record of 13,208 tonnes, handled from Agia Charis on July 30. OUR BUREAU

Centre reconstitutes CBFC panel with 18 members

New Delhi: The government, on Wednesday, said that it has reconstituted the Central Board of Film Certification, with immediate effect for three years or until further orders, bringing actors Preity Zinta, Pankaj Tripathi, Suniel Shetty, Pallavi Joshi, Prosenjit Chatterjee and the Grammy-winning Ricky Kej, among others, onto the 18-member board. Two members of the previous board, Waman Kendre and Ramesh Patange, have been retained. OUR BUREAU

SC refuses to reconstitute committee probing NEET protests violence

DEEP ANGUISH. Expresses a sense of chagrin about premature disparagement from the petitioners’ side

Krishnadas Rajagopal
New Delhi

The Supreme Court has expressed “disquiet” at petitioners’ aspersions of ‘conflict of interest’ within its high-powered enquiry committee (HPEC) formed to probe into the police crack-down on Cockroach Janta Party protests on July 20.

Refusing to re-constitute the HPEC, a three-judge Bench, headed by the Chief Justice of India Surya Kant, criticised the petitioners, who include students, of indulging in “conjecture and preconceived notions”.

The committee, headed by former SC judge R Subhash Reddy, includes Justice Ravi Shankar Jha, former Chief Justice of the Punjab and Haryana High Court; Justice Shalinder Kaur, former judge of the Delhi High Court; Rishi Kumar Shukla, former



WEB ACCESS. The Supreme Court ordered the launch of an online portal for vulnerable witnesses to submit supporting documents to the HPEC directly

Director of the Central Bureau of Investigation; and LR Bishnoi, retired Director General of Police, Meghalaya.

The petitioners, represented by senior advocates N Hariharan, Gopal Sankaranarayanan, advocates Prashant Bhushan, Vrinda Grover and Neha Rathi, clarified that they were not apprehending bias, but the committee should inspire

confidence too.

However, the court expressed a sense of chagrin that the disparagement from the petitioners’ side had commenced even before the HPEC started work.

NO ALTERATION

“We are constrained to observe, with some measure of disquiet, that aspersions have been cast upon the HPEC in a manner that is

both premature and precipitate. In the circumstances, we are not inclined to effect any alteration in the constitution of the Committee, particularly where the prayer for such reconstitution proceeds on nothing more than conjecture and preconceived notions, articulated even before the HPEC has embarked upon its enquiry,” the Supreme Court observed in its September 10 order, published on Wednesday.

The court underscored the fact that the HPEC was constituted to assist the Supreme Court itself, with the “highest standards of fairness and transparency and with a dispassionate approach.” “The HPEC is not created to espouse the causes of one or the other party before us.”

It reiterated that the immediate focus of the HPEC enquiry would be on the use of pellet guns, the targeted

violence, harassment of female protestors and the excessive violence and destruction of property by both sides. It further ordered the launch of an online portal for vulnerable witnesses to submit supporting documents to the HPEC directly. It directed the HPEC to protect these witnesses, and keep their identities and participation confidential.

The Bench appointed senior advocate Monika Gulsain and advocate-on-record C Solomon as *amici curiae* in the case to assist the court and act as independent arbiters. The court said “broader constitutional questions” would be taken up for hearing at the “appropriate stage.” These issues involve the use of facial recognition surveillance by the police at the Jantar Mantar protest site and the alleged storage of that data with private entities.

‘Encourage reverse brain drain to enhance India’s biopharma innovation’

PT Jyothi Datta
Mumbai



Encourage a reverse “brain drain,” say representatives of the clinical research community, citing the China example to help the Indian biopharmaceutical industry make the research journey from generics to innovative medicines.

Over a 15-year-plus timeframe, China created an innovative ecosystem and is today able to have “an inside-out product ... from China to the world,” Anirban Roychowdhury, Honorary General Secretary with the Indian Society for Clinical Research (ISCR), told *businessline*.

RETURN TO INDIA

The Chinese government, through its “Thousand talents programme,” attracted scientific talent back to the country, he said, adding that several members of the Indian diaspora, who work in the international biopharmaceutical industry as scientists or are part of the international regulatory framework as reviewers, could be brought back to India for their expertise. That will help address the immediate manpower requirement, with highly technical and resourceful manpower.

In fact, the Centre has been increasingly pushing the domestic pharmaceutical industry to move up the innovation curve.

TRANSLATIONAL LABS

And biotechnology, healthcare and medtech are among the 13 priority sectors outlined by the Prime Minister Research Chair (PMRC) scheme that seeks to attract researchers from abroad to national research institutions, for example, to help build an innovative ecosystem.

tem, said the clinical research industry representative.

The Centre has shown its intent with the ₹10,000-crore BioPharma Shakti funding announcement, among other things, but to move into the innovation space, the industry requires early-stage translational labs that do the job much faster, said Roychowdhury.

This involves discovery of the molecule, translating that discovery from the lab and developing it further, he said, adding that such infrastructure needs to come up in academic institutions and hospitals for situations that involve the first exposure of the molecule to humans, for example.

Besides putting in place early-stage translational labs, he said, regulatory bandwidth to evaluate newer therapies and biologicals need to be addressed, and approval times for such discoveries need to be improved. Otherwise, companies would go to locations in Europe or Australia, where they get a better ecosystem.

Medical device margins back in focus after Maharashtra FDA survey

PT Jyothi Datta
Mumbai

The maze of trade margins that come between a patient and the price they pay for a consumable used in a hospital has come into sharp focus again, following a survey by the Maharashtra Food and Drug Administration (FDA) under Commissioner Tukaram Mundhe, who has been cracking down on food and drug companies running foul of the law.

About nine years ago, the National Pharmaceutical Pricing Authority (NPPA) had laid threadbare how

trade margins — between 11 and 1,000 per cent at different levels — increased the final cost of a stent for a patient.

STEEP MARKUPS

Revealing findings from a survey by the State FDA, Mundhe said, “The most expensive part of a hospital bill may never touch the hospital at all.”

“A patient admitted for care has no way of knowing whether the price on a medical consumable reflects its actual cost or a markup fixed long before it ever reached the ward. That gap in information is, at its core, a public

health issue,” he said in a post on the survey findings.

“A survey of hospital consumables in Maharashtra found a syringe procured at ₹6.75 carried an MRP of ₹57.20. A catheter procured at ₹29.41 carried an MRP of ₹310,” he said, adding that a patient is not in a position to compare prices, seek alternatives, or question the printed MRP while seeking care.

CLEAR GUIDELINES

Besides, the MRP is “often fixed upstream by manufacturers and distributors, disconnected from the trade price by a wide, unexplained margin. The result is a sys-

tem where the party bearing the cost has the least information to evaluate it.”

Mundhe pointed out that the “regulatory gap is structural: scheduled medicines are capped under the Drugs (Prices Control) Order, 2013. Most medical devices and consumables are not, leaving both the pricing and the information around it almost entirely unmonitored.”

To help bridge the “information gap” that patients face, he called on the Department of Pharmaceuticals and the NPPA to review their findings and issue “clear guidelines on the permissible gap between trade pro-

curement price and declared MRP.”

“Consumables are the biggest pain-point,” said Rajiv Nath with the Association of Indian Medical Device Industry (AiMed), calling for a trade-margin cap at four-six times the ex-factory or landed import prices. “Rational profits for any business is understandable but not irrational profiteering,” he said, adding that inflated prices could point to possible tax evasion, as well.

INADEQUATE NORMS

Further, he said, the current regulatory framework under the Drugs (Prices Control)

Order, 2013 was “inadequate” for medical devices.

Pointing to the FDA Commissioner’s findings, the industry platform called for “structured price monitoring and margin rationalisation”, starting with pilot studies to generate data.

“Patients, who cannot bargain or choose devices, are left vulnerable to inflated MRPs, while ethical manufacturers and importers are forced to either play within a distorted system or exit the market. This situation penalises both consumers and responsible suppliers, eroding trust and competitiveness,” AiMed said.

Trev sues Trevel over EV-cab brand as rivals chase ₹22,000 crore market

Amit Vijay Mohile
Mumbai

Trev and Trevel differ by two letters. On September 18, that difference returns to the Delhi High Court as two electric cab operators fight over who can use the closely-named brands while racing to expand roughly five-fold their combined fleet of about 200 EVs and chase a share of Delhi-NCR’s commercial electric fleet market, estimated to reach ₹18,000-22,000 crore by 2030.

Naveen Gupta’s Trev Mobility has sued Sahil Jindal-led Trevel, operated by Inwisement Technologies, alleging trademark infringement and passing off through its use of the Trevel name.

Trev has sought an interim injunction, but the High Court has not granted one so far. Nor has the court de-

termined whether Trevel had infringed on Trev’s trademark or committed passing off.

FIGHT OVER A NAME

The business race, meanwhile, isn’t waiting for the legal one.

Both operators are targeting fleets of roughly 500 vehicles each.

Trev began operations in January 2024, while Trevel entered in December 2025. Both operate premium EVs in Delhi-NCR and target corporate and airport-travel customers.

Trev also alleges similarities in Trev’s vehicle branding and trade dress. These remain Trev’s allegations and have not been adjudicated by the High Court.

An email sent to Trevel went unanswered. HKS Legal, representing Trevel, too, did not provide any response.



COURT ORDER

On April 10, Justice Tushar Rao Gedela referred the parties to mediation, saying, “In case the mediation talks are not successful, this court will take up the matter on merits.”

On July 27, Justice Anup Jairam Bhambhani ordered: “Let the plaintiff be registered as a suit. Issue summons in the suit.” Inwisement Technologies accepted the summons and was given 30 days

to file its written statement.

On Trev’s separate application seeking an interim injunction, the court ordered, “Issue notice.”

Inwisement accepted notice and was allowed two weeks to reply, followed by one week for Trev’s rejoinder. The order said the matter should be re-notified on September 18.

A senior lawyer at a Mumbai-based law firm, on condition of anonymity, said disputes involving short names turn on whether the shared element is distinctive and whether additions change the overall impression.

“The question is not simply whether one name contains another,” he said. “It is whether the part that has been taken is distinctive of the first business and whether what has been added is enough to change the overall impression the later name creates.”

SFO Technologies unveils primary power distribution system for Saras MKII

Our Bureau
Kochi



KEY MILESTONE. (from left) Nazneen Jehangir, ED & CEO, Software Division, NeST Group; Krishnadas Nair, former CMD, HAL; N Jehangir, CMD, NeST Group; and Abhay A Pashilkar, Director, CSIR-NAL, at the NeST Hi-Tek Park, Kalamassery

Giving a major boost to the nation’s indigenous civil aviation capabilities, SFO Technologies, the flagship aerospace and defence division of the NeST Group, has successfully handed over the first airworthy unit of the primary power distribution system (PPDS) for Saras MKII — India’s first indigenous passenger aircraft.

The state-of-the-art power system, jointly designed and developed with the Bengaluru-based CSIR-National Aerospace Laboratories (CSIR-NAL), was officially unveiled and handed over at a ceremony held at SFO’s Hi Tek Park in Kalamassery.

Designed to meet stringent airworthiness standards, the PPDS will serve as the electrical nerve centre

for the 19-seater Saras MKII aircraft. It manages electrical power generated by the aircraft’s twin turboprop engines, distributing power to mission-critical onboard systems.

NATIONAL MISSION

It also features smart monitoring capabilities that allow real-time tracking of critical

components of the PPDS via the central flight computer.

N Jehangir, Chairman and Managing Director of NeST Group, said, “SFO is proud to partner with NAL on this national mission. This success strengthens our resolve to take on even more complex aerospace challenges in the future.”

Abhay Anant Pashilkar,

Director, CSIR-NAL, said that PPDS is the heart of Saras MKII electrical system powering complete aircraft having multiple sources from generators and batteries.

The Saras MKII programme has completed the critical design reviews of all systems and is heading towards the aircraft-level critical design review.

NeST Digital, the software division under SFO, developed the software powering the PPDS in-house; it specialises in high-criticality avionics, automotive and healthcare solutions.

The Saras MKII, designed and developed by CSIR-NAL, aims to bolster regional air connectivity under the Centre’s Udaan scheme, connecting remote hubs across the country while also being certified for military transport duties with the Air Force.

AI-led changes bring techies back to IT offices

Rohan Das
Chennai



AI-led changes are bringing Indian techies back to the office. Monthly job openings that are full-time work from office (WFO) have seen a steady spike over the past year, show data from specialist staffing firm Xpheno.

September 2026 saw 92,000 WFO roles, up 26 per cent from the 72,000 roles in the same month last year.

On the other hand, full-time remote or work from home (WFH) roles declined 21 per cent on year to 11,000.

Hybrid roles also declined 7 per cent to 14,000 openings.

THE REASONS

Speaking to *businessline*, HR executives suggested that the collaborative nature of IT work, alongside the erosion in the cost advantages of remote work, had led

to companies returning to the older format.

Anil Ethanur, Co-Founder, Xpheno, said that in the immediate period after the pandemic, multiple IT/ITes and BPM industries saw remote and hybrid models delivering a spike in productivity and profitability. “But these gains were difficult to sustain. Benefits of a low overhead costs model eventually eroded and brought the focus back to sustainable productivity over the long term,” he said.

The shift has been accelerated, with firms integrating

AI and automation into their projects requiring tighter coordination between employees and quicker integration between multiple teams.

MAKING A DIFFERENCE Neelabh Shukla, Chief Business Officer, Careernet, said most remote work that was voluminous and routine in nature had now been automated. “Today, with AI re-shaping how work is designed, especially for early-career talent, companies believe that hands-on learning and direct exposure to experienced teams can make a difference,” he said.

The emergence of specialist talent like FDEs, which require domain specific and client facing work, is also playing a role.

Neeti Sharma, CEO, Teamlease, said, “With flatter teams and fewer layers of managers, companies are using the office more deliberately as a place for learning.”

Lam to invest ₹10,000 cr in silicon component plant

Our Bureau
Bengaluru

Lam Research Corp announced it intends to invest approximately ₹10,000 crore in its first silicon component manufacturing facility in India and augment its advanced research and development operations.

The planned investment reflects Lam’s long-term approach to invest across key aspects of the semiconductor ecosystem in India. The company trained thousands of individuals for the semiconductor industry through workforce development programmes.

The investment represents the next phase of development to support customers worldwide, as semiconductor complexity accelerates in the AI era.

The facility will support a

vertically-integrated process spanning silicon ingot production and processing for advanced semiconductor technologies and leading-edge nodes.

The planned augmentation to R&D builds on Lam’s India Center for Engineering.

GLOBAL STRATEGY

“India represents an important part of Lam’s global innovation and growth strategy,” said Rangesh Raghavan, Corporate Vice-President and Managing Director, Lam Research India.

“Our continuing expansion in India reflects our confidence in the country’s talent, growing semiconductor ecosystem, and supportive policy environment,” he added.

Lam intends to make the investment over the next several years.

Keralam steps up push to fast-track flagship projects, attract investments

Our Bureau
Kochi

Keralam Chief Minister VD Satheesan has said the State government is prioritising the time-bound implementation of flagship projects while ensuring quality, as it steps up efforts to attract investments and take the ‘Invest in Keralam’ message to the global markets.

Speaking at the inauguration of the three-day ‘Reimagining Keralam’ initiative, which features a series of roundtable conferences, Satheesan said the programme would help evolve a framework for fast-tracking transformational projects announced in the State’s 2026-27 Budget.

“We need to adopt a modern approach to project execution and ensure that pro-

jects are result-oriented,” he added.

LEVERAGING DIASPORA

Satheesan said the support of the Malayali diaspora could be leveraged, particularly for income-generating projects. Keralam has considerable investment potential, especially in the aviation and maritime sectors, which needs to be effectively harnessed.

Highlighting Keralam’s strengths in sectors such as healthcare and education, he said the State’s talent pool should be showcased globally. The government’s focus was also on creating more opportunities for young people to pursue careers in Keralam.

PK Kunhalikutty, Industries Minister, said it is vital to create conducive ecosystem by leveraging cutting-

edge technology in every sector to pave the way for attracting investments in a big way.

KM Chandrasekhar, Vice-Chairperson, State Planning Board, said the ideas and suggestions emerging from the roundtables will be consolidated to prepare the 15th Five-Year Plan in a different mode.

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